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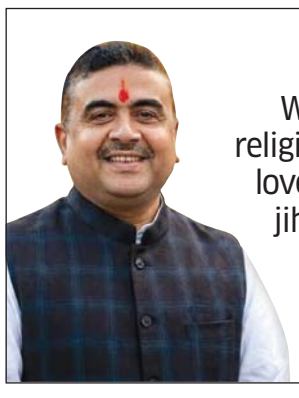
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Trump targets Indian IT giants

US suspends Infosys, Tata, Wipro, HCL from green card programme

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi



The Trump administration has widened its crackdown on foreign-worker programmes, suspending major Indian IT companies, including Infosys, Tata, Wipro, and HCL, along with Cognizant and Capgemini, from the US programme employers use to sponsor skilled foreign workers for permanent residency.

US labor secretary Keith Sonderling said the Department of Labor was suspending the companies from the Permanent Labor Certification (PERM) programme, citing alleged misuse of the system. The department also suspended Microsoft and Adobe and said it would not process new or pending labour-certification applications from the affected companies.

The action matters for Indian technology professionals because PERM is a key step in the employment-based green-card process. It is separate from the H-1B programme, but many foreign technology workers use H-1B status for temporary employment before their employers seek permanent residency on their behalf.

> THE DEPARTMENT OF LABOR WAS SUSPENDING THE COMPANIES FROM THE PERMANENT LABOR CERTIFICATION (PERM) PROGRAMME, CITING ALLEGED MISUSE OF THE SYSTEM
> –US LABOR SECRETARY KEITH SONDERLING

Vice President JD Vance, announcing the action, accused companies of abusing the immigration system and said the administration wanted US employers to prioritise American workers. Sonderling separately named Cognizant, Infosys, Tata, Wipro, HCL and Capgemini among the major IT outsourcing companies being suspended. The allegations have not been established in court.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

GST Council eases norms, scraps arrest powers

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi



Union Minister for Finance and Corporate Affairs Nirmala Sitharaman during the 57th meeting of the Goods and Services Tax (GST) Council in New Delhi PTI

The Goods and Services Tax (GST) Council on Thursday recommended several changes to ease compliance, reduce procedural burdens, and simplify the GST regime, while keeping the existing tax rate structure unchanged. Among the key decisions, the Council scrapped the arrest powers of tax officers and raised the threshold for prosecution to ₹5 crore from ₹1 crore.

It also recommended common standards for GST notices and proceedings and decided not to issue notices for monetary amounts of ₹10,000 or below. It will also withdraw pending notices below the threshold. The GST Council will implement the changes from April 1, 2027.

Announcing the decisions taken at the 57th meeting of the GST Council, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman said it also decided to bring down the general penalty from ₹25,000 to ₹10,000. "GST Council today has recommended common standards for notices and proceedings and no notices below the prescribed monetary threshold of ₹10,000, including withdrawal of pending notices below the said threshold. We will not be issuing any notices for monetary thresholds of ₹10,000 or below. We will also withdraw pending notices below the said threshold. If it was issued, it will be withdrawn," said Sitharaman after the meeting.

> THE POWER TO ARREST WILL BE REMOVED UNDER GST, AND THE PROSECUTION THRESHOLD WILL BE RAISED FROM ₹1 CRORE TO ₹5 CRORE
> –FINANCE MINISTER NIRMALA SITHARAMAN

Sitharaman said the power to arrest will be removed under GST, and the prosecution threshold will be raised from ₹1 crore to ₹5 crore.

The finance minister said the principle of trust drives the GST 2.0 process reform and is part of the 'Reform Express' under Prime Minister Narendra Modi.

A Committee of Officers, expected to submit its report within 3 months, will examine how the protect a genuine buyer who holds a proper invoice, has received the goods, and has paid his supplier in full.

The Council, comprising Union and state finance ministers, also recommended removing the minimum punishment. The Council also left the punishment, whether a fine, imprisonment, or both, to judicial discretion in each case. The Council also approved a simplified GST registration mechanism for small sellers operating through e-commerce platforms.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

The ByStander





Prime Minister Narendra Modi addresses the gathering during the inauguration of the 10th edition of the India Mobile Congress (IMC) 2026 in New Delhi PTI

Digital India plugged welfare leakages: PM

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ New Delhi

Vowing to continue his fight against "wrong practices" for the good of people in need, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Thursday said India's digital governance push has helped plug leakages in Government welfare schemes, with nearly ₹5 lakh crore saved from going into "wrong hands," thanks to direct benefit transfers.

Highlighting this achievement, he said nearly ₹50 lakh crore had been transferred directly to beneficiaries' bank accounts through the Direct Benefit Transfer (DBT), helping ensure that Government aid reached its intended recipients.

Making these assertions at the inaugural session of the Indian Mobile Congress, the Prime Minister also called for a global framework to tackle cross-border cyber frauds and the growing threat of deep fakes.

He urged Governments, technology companies, telecom operators, and financial institutions to come together to prevent such frauds before they reach the people. He said India has gained considerable experience in tackling cyber frauds and is ready to share its learnings with the world.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

Day 3: INDIA bloc takes protest to Rajghat

ABHINAV KUMAR JHA
■ New Delhi


Congress President Mallikarjun Kharge and party leader Rahul Gandhi about to board a bus towards Mahatma Gandhi's memorial at Rajghat for a peaceful protest in New Delhi PANKAJ KUMAR

Opposition MPs led by Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge and Lok Sabha Leader of Opposition Rahul Gandhi held a sit-in at Rajghat on Thursday, the third consecutive day of protests demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar over the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. Opposition leaders said the agitation would continue until Kumar steps down.

The day began with tight security around the Sansad Marg roundabout in central Delhi, where the MPs had been expected to gather. Delhi Police and central forces cordoned off approaches to the protest sites. The Congress had declared October 8 a "Black Day for Indian Democracy". General Secretary KC Venugopal directed State, district and block units to hold demonstrations. Protests were also reported in Patna, where RJD leader Tejashwi Yadav led an INDIA bloc march, and in Agartala.

Kharge hosted the MPs for lunch at Moets in Connaught Place, a day after a similar meeting at Sagar Ratna on Janpath. The MPs then boarded buses for Rajghat, where thousands of supporters walked alongside. Among those present were Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, Venugopal, Vivek Tankha, Manickam Tagore, Jothimani, Rajiv Shukla and Deepender Hooda. The MPs stayed at the memorial for about an hour before leaving.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

BJP ACCUSES PRIYANKA OF PUNCHING COP

New Delhi: As the Congress intensified its protest, the BJP on Thursday accused Rahul Gandhi of "inappropriately touching" a female constable and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra of "punching" a cop during their street protest, and claimed that the Congress leaders' actions were not consistent with their slogan of "smash the patriarchy".

The Congress was also trying to create "Nepal-and Bangladesh-like anarchy" in the country through its protests, as Rahul Gandhi is "desperate" to come to power, BJP spokesperson Pradeep Bhandari alleged.

Addressing a press conference at the BJP headquarters here, party spokesperson Sidharth Yadav accused Rahul and Priyanka of attacking police personnel during the protests. Yadav said the visuals being circulated were not of a protest but showed "the anarchy being spread in the national Capital" under the leadership of Rahul Gandhi and the Congress.

He alleged that Rahul "inappropriately touched" a woman police constable and claimed that Priyanka "punched a female police officer in the stomach".

FULL REPORT ON >> P5

Musk questions Ambani's clout, Centre hits back

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
■ New Delhi



World's richest businessman Elon Musk sharpened a public quarrel over satellite internet on Thursday by asking whether one of India's richest men decides who gets a licence. "Starlink is licenced in over 165 countries and has spent five years complying with every single law and requirement of the Government of India, so why still no licence? Is Ambani the real boss of India?" he wrote on X, replying to a post that accused the Government of protecting crony capitalists.

The line landed while the India Mobile Congress was underway in the Capital and the telecom ministry was still responding to an earlier accusation. On Wednesday, Musk had said Starlink was "being blocked by certain oligarchs to maintain their monopolistic chokehold on the Indian people." He added, "You can guess who they are... This is a crime against the people of India!" He named no firm then. The Thursday post removed the guesswork.

The Ministry of Communications rejected the charge. It said the authorisation framework for telecom and satellite services is "fair and non-discriminatory," and called any suggestion that the rules were being applied selectively "baseless and misconceived." Three companies hold licences: Musk's Starlink, Reliance Jio's satellite venture and Bharti-backed Eutelsat OneWeb. None may sell service until security assessments and spectrum-related approvals are finished. Officials said those assessments are underway for all three licensees, and the companies remain "broadly at the same regulatory stage."

Minister of State for Communications Chandra Sekhar Pemmasani made the same point on the sidelines of the congress. The Department of Telecommunications has already issued licences and provisional spectrum, he said. What remains sits with the Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA). "As soon as it is cleared, they will get it. It has nothing to do with one company."

The dispute is not only about paperwork. Reliance Jio, Bharti Airtel and Vodafone Idea dominate India's mobile market.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

SC seeks stronger security, for women

RAJESH KUMAR ■ New Delhi

Giving top priority to the safety of women, especially after recent incidents of crimes against them in Delhi-NCR, the Supreme Court on Thursday issued a series of directions to the police and State Government to strengthen preventive measures, public transport security and surveillance.

Invoking the "Broken Windows" theory of policing while hearing the suo motu case it initiated over recent incidents of rape in Delhi



NCR, a bench of Justice JB Pardiwala and Justice K Vinod Chandran observed that a broken streetlight, a non-functional CCTV camera or an unattended complaint, though minor in isolation, together convey that public spaces are not being watched. The bench similarly noted that visible and unattended signs of civic neglect signal an absence of authority and create a haven for anti-social elements.

FULL REPORT ON >> P8

From *Darr* to *Dhanda*, Nana Patekar's unforgettable screen legacy

RAHUL DATTA
■ New Delhi/Mumbai





Veteran actor Nana Patekar passed away on Thursday at the age of 75 at his residence in Dona Paula, Goa

"*Darr sirf ek veham hai. Jo Darr gaya, samjho mar gaya*," in the film *Prahaar* as a no-nonsense Army officer, and "*Dhande mein koi kisi ka Bhai nahin, koi kisi ka beta nahin*," portraying ruthless underworld don Anna Seth in the film *Parinda*, Nana Patekar transcended the conventional grammar of Hindi film acting.

Endearing himself to cinegoers with his versatility in several other films, the 75-year-old actor passed away on Thursday morning following a cardiac arrest at his home in Goa. He was later cremated in Pune with full State honours. Incidentally, Patekar also directed *Prahaar*.

Patekar did not confine himself to the make-believe world. He trained as a rifle shooter in his early 50s and competed at the national level. He also donned the Army uniform and spent more than two months with frontline troops during the Kargil War.

He was also a philanthropist who carried out social work through the NGO Naam Foundation and received acclaim for its work with farmers during a drought in Maharashtra.

Away from films, the actor had a very different idea of what a good life looked like. For years, his Pune farmhouse gave him a break from Mumbai and a chance to do something he genuinely enjoyed: farming.

Prime Minister Narendra Modi expressed condolences and said the actor gave the audience characters that will be remembered for generations.

Paying tributes, Modi described Patekar as a *Krantiveer* (revolutionary) and said that through his film with the same name, the actor strongly attacked the evils prevalent in society. Incidentally, Patekar had played the lead role in the hugely successful film named *Krantiveer*.

"Few actors possessed the intensity, individuality and unmistakable presence that Shri Nana Patekar Ji had. He brought remarkable versatility and creativity to every role and gave us characters that will be remembered for generations," Modi said in a post on social media.

CONTINUED ON >> P4

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13 lakh challans for illegal parking; LG pushes for unified authority

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Delhi Traffic Police has so far issued over 13 lakh challans and 5.54 lakh notices for unauthorised parking in the national capital, with Lt Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu on Thursday directing agencies to intensify action through joint enforcement to check illegal parking.

Chairing a high-level meeting to review chronic parking issues in the city, Sandhu directed officials to explore if adoption of FASTag and app-based real-time slot tracking, along with automated sensor ticketing, could be mandated to minimise manual intervention.

In the meeting, the Municipal Corporation of Delhi (MCD) presented a district-wise enforcement plan from October 15 to December 15, covering identified parking hotspots and market corridors, to be carried out with the Traffic Police.

The Delhi Traffic Police presented that till October 5 this year, 13,34,700 challans and 5,54,073 notices were issued for unauthorised parking and 1,24,906 vehicles were towed, with 76 cranes deployed.

Heads of stakeholder agencies including the Traffic Police, MCD, New Delhi Municipal Corporation (NDMC) and the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) among others discussed the national capital's persistent parking issues and mobility bottlenecks in the meeting chaired by the LG, said a Lok Niwas note.

Sandhu directed officials to examine the possibility of providing dedicated EV charging points at all existing and newly proposed public parking sites.

The proposed integration of all MCD and NDMC-managed parking on the Park+ app, with live display of vacant and occupied slots and data sharing with Google Maps and MapmyIndia, was also discussed.

He emphasised that the residents of the national capital required ample parking facilities beyond what existed today, and directed the officials to work in a coordinated manner and develop new parking spaces and infrastructure.

After assessing existing surface and multi-level parking facility sites and spaces and their under-utilisation in many cases, the LG directed the MCD, NDMC and the Traffic Police to plan joint enforcement exercises against illegal parking at such sites and locations.

He pressed for uniform parking charges across all agencies, namely the MCD, NDMC, Delhi Development Authority (DDA) and the DMRC. The existing rules and process for deciding parking charges, which differ across agencies, were placed before the meeting, it said.

The MCD's base rate for cars is ₹20 per hour, the NDMC's on-street rate is ₹50 per hour and the DMRC charges ₹30 for up to six hours.

The LG called for an early decision on the creation of a unified parking authority for Delhi and directed the MCD, NDMC, DDA and the Delhi Police to prepare the framework for the authority, Lok Niwas said.

Involving RWAs and market associations for better enforcement outside multi-level parking facilities, to prevent unauthorised parking The MCD, NDMC and the DDA were instructed to ensure that all existing parking sites are utilised fully and their utilisation is increased.

The MCD, DDA and the Traffic Police will also jointly plan area-wise parking requirements and execute them using new technologies.

The MCD has 463 parking sites (433 surface and 30 multi-level or stack parking) with a capacity of 94,831 equivalent car spaces.

It has identified 79 new sites, which will take the total to 542 by December this year and has 14 multi-level and stack parking proposals with a capacity of 6,052 equivalent car spaces under consideration, the note said.

The NDMC has 126 existing parking sites and is planning to bring parking sites in its area under an intelligent, integrated parking system shortly. Lok Niwas said that the DMRC will scale up its Park-and-Ride facilities across Metro stations.

The DMRC currently has such facilities at 127 of its 242 Metro stations across Delhi-NCR, with a total capacity of 1,34,985 vehicles. This comprises 14,426 four-wheelers, 1,09,250 two-wheelers and 11,309 cycles.

Ten of these are multi-level car parking. Of the 127 sites, 65 are smart parking sites, of which 52 are integrated with the DMRC app, and the remaining sites are planned to be converted in a phased manner, it added.

CM orders safety audit at DU North Campus

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Wednesday night directed officials to fix dark spots, damaged footpaths and gaps in CCTV coverage at Delhi University's North Campus after speaking to students about their safety concerns. During a surprise inspection of the campus, the Chief Minister interacted with women students outside the Arts Faculty and asked about problems related to safety, transport, hostels, colleges and movement at night.

She told students to report difficulties faced on campus and assured them that genuine concerns would be addressed.

The Chief Minister personally identified several poorly lit stretches during the inspection and sought details from officials. She directed them to identify all dark spots and install additional lights wherever required. The inspection also highlighted damaged and uneven footpaths. The Chief Minister directed officials to inspect the entire campus and repair stretches that could make walking difficult. She specifically asked officials to consider the needs of students with disabilities while carrying out the repairs.

She also reviewed the campus CCTV network, asking officials about the number of cameras installed, their functioning status and locations requiring additional surveillance. She directed officials to install cameras wherever necessary and ensure that existing systems remain functional. She said sensitive areas should not remain outside the surveillance network.

The Chief Minister also sought feedback from students about police arrangements at night, including the presence of women police personnel and PCR vehicles. Students told her that women police personnel were deployed at night and PCR vehicles responded promptly when required. The Chief Minister stressed coordination between Delhi Police and the university administration to strengthen security.

Cleanliness was another issue flagged during the visit. After noticing garbage and poorly maintained green areas, the Chief Minister directed officials to ensure immediate cleaning and better maintenance.

Yamuna pollution up at 3 sites, BOD above limit

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

The Yamuna River, which enters Delhi at Palla Village and exits at Jaitpur, saw a slight deterioration in water quality at certain locations in September, with faecal coliform levels dropping sharply from the previous month, according to the Delhi Pollution Control Committee (DPCC).

The Biological Oxygen Demand (BOD) levels, meanwhile, remained high and well beyond the permissible limit for September. DPCC water quality testing involves collecting water samples from seven locations along the Yamuna River through the national capital and measuring parameters such as BOD, dissolved oxygen, chemical oxygen demand, pH, and faecal coliform to determine pollution levels.

The seven locations include major points like Palla, Wazirabad, ISBT Bridge, ITO Bridge, Nizamudin Bridge, Okhla Barrage and Yamuna River at Asgarpur (Kidwali, Haryana). Three locations showed further deterioration, two showed slight improvement, and two showed no change from the August data.

The September report showed improvement at Palla, as faecal coliform levels fell to 1100 Most Probable Number per 100 millilitres (MPN/100 ml), down from 1400 MPN/100 ml in August. MPN provides a statistical estimate of viable microorganism concentration in a sample. The river also improved at Okhla Barrage, where faecal coliform levels remained at 21,000 (MPN/100 ml) in September, down from 23,000 in August.

The three locations which showed deterioration were Wazirabad, where faecal coliform levels increased to 1,300 MPN/100 ml in September from 1,100 MPN/100 ml in August; Nizamudin Bridge where the level went from 13,000 MPN/100 ml to 15,000 MPN/100 ml; and Yamuna river at Asgarpur where the level increased from 36,000 MPN/100 ml in August to 38,000 MPN/100 ml in September.

Two locations showed no change: ISBT Bridge (35,000 MPN/100 ml) and ITO Bridge (17,000 MPN/100 ml).

BOD levels for September remained beyond the permissible limit at certain locations, ranging from 2-30 milligrams per litre (mg/l), while the water quality criteria stipulates a maximum of 3 mg/l.



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Candidates may visit **https://gate2027.iitm.ac.in** or any of the GATE zonal websites of IISc and IITs for detailed information on GATE 2027.

Any further information/corrigendum/addendum would be uploaded only on the NPCIL websites mentioned above.

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SBI STATE BANK OF INDIA,
Home Loan Centre, First Floor, Main Branch Building, Neelam Chowk, NIT, Faridabad-121001.

PUBLIC NOTICE- LOST DOCUMENT

STATE BANK OF INDIA, Home Loan Centre, First Floor, Main Branch Building, Neelam Chowk, NIT, Faridabad-121001, hereby informs the General public that the original documents of Property at **Plot No. 1770, Area, 138.85 sq.mtr. Sector-65, Urban Estate(HSVP), Tehsil- Ballabhgarh, Faridabad, Haryana in the name of Ms Manisha, W/o Sh. Hardayal Singh,** which were mortgaged against the SBI Home Loan 38761916538 are lost/misplaced while shifting of branch premises from **SBI, RACPC Branch (11528), S.C.O 98, 1st and 2nd Floor, Sector-16, Faridabad-121002, Haryana** to **SBI, Home Loan Centre (11528), 1st Floor, Main Branch Building, Neelam Chowk, NIT, Faridabad-121001** during 21.01.2024 to 25.01.2024 .

The list of documents are as below:

1. **ORIGINAL SALE DEED NO. 5181 DATED 13/09/2019. SR Ballabhgarh.**
2. **ORIGINAL SALE DEED NO. 5896 DATED 09/09/2013. SR Ballabhgarh.**
3. **ORIGINAL CONVEYANCE DEED NO. 5895 DATED 09/09/2013. SR Ballabhgarh.**
4. **DIGITAL COPY OF OCCUPTION CERTIFICATE DATED 31/01/2025.**
5. **ORIGINAL ALLOTMENT LETTER DATED 21/02/2005.**
6. **PHOTOCOPY OF GENERAL POWER OF ATTORNEY DATED 30/07/2010.**
7. **ORIGINAL POSSESSION CERTIFICATE DATED 11/10/2010.**
8. **ORIGINAL RE-ALLOTMENT LETTER DATED 10/01/2011**
9. **ORIGINAL RE-ALLOTMENT LETTER DATED 22/10/2013.**
10. **ORIGINAL AGREEMENT TO SELL DATED 19/08/2019.**
11. **DIGITAL COPY OF TRANSFER PERMISSION LETTER DATED 27/08/2019.**
12. **DIGITAL COPY OF RE-ALLOTMENT LETTER DATED 29/09/2019.**

The documents could not be traced despite best efforts. Any person having any information regarding the above-mentioned documents or having possession of the same is requested to contact the undersigned immediately.

Date: 08/10/2026 (Branch Head, State Bank of India)
Place: Faridabad Home Loan Centre, First Floor, Neelam Chowk, NIT, Faridabad

District Consumer Disputes Redressal Commission-X (SOUTH-EAST)
Government of NCT of Delhi
Udyog Sadan, C-22 & 23, Qutub Institutional Area, 3rd Floor, (Behind Qutab Hotel), New Delhi-110016

Case No. 289/25, Despatch No.1362/16.09.2026

NOTICE

Smt. Himani Sharma .....Comp.
V/s
Shri Surender Singh
Director, JMS Developers & Co.
Office No.21, Ashiayana Comples, Dharamveer Market, Near Metro Pillar-37, Badarpur, New Delhi-110044

Branch Office at: Shri Surender Singh S/o Shri Mahender Singh. Director- JMS Developer & Co., Shop No-14, Master Road, Near Veervati Vatika Kheri Road, Sector-87, Greater Faridabad-121002.

Residence at: Shri Surender Singh S/o Shri Mahender Singh, House No. 37 (Near Hanuman Mandir) Village Kulesara, Pushta Road, District Gautam Budh Nagar, UP-201306 ..... Op. 1

Kalka Properties,
Ismailpur Extn, Ajay Nagar, Gali No. 2
Faridabad, HR-121013 .....Op. 2

This is to inform you that aforementioned case has been noted for hearing on **27.10.2026** for purpose of further proceedings. You are directed to attend the sitting of the Commission at **10:30 A.M.** to the aforesaid date along with your pleading/ evidence in the form of the affidavit, if not fixed earlier for the final hearing.

Sd/-
For President DCDRC-X

पीएम श्री केंद्रीय विद्यालय वायु सेना स्टेशन,
रजोकरी, नई दिल्ली – 110038

निविदा सूचना

पीएम श्री केंद्रीय विद्यालय वायु सेना स्थल रजोकरी –110038,विद्यालय में कैंटीन सेवाएँ, टेंट सामग्री, स्टेशनरी सामग्री, विद्यालय मरम्मत सिविल, इलेक्ट्रिकल, प्लंबिंग, वैल्डिंग, विज्ञान प्रयोगशाला, खेलकूद, computer, camera, आदि सामग्री के लिए प्रतिष्ठित एवं पंजीकृत सेवा प्रदाता फर्मों से निविदा आमंत्रित करता है, निविदा प्रपत्र कार्य दिवस में प्रातः 10 बजे से 2 बजे तक प्राप्त की जा सकती है और निविदाओं में विद्यालय पहुँचने की अन्तिम तिथि 2 बजे 27.10.2026 होगी, इसके बाद प्राप्त निविदाओं पर विचार नहीं किया जायेगा और केवल पंजीकृत डाक से आई निविदाएँ ही स्वीकृत होंगी

प्राचार्य

No. GSGSS/Misc/2026 Dated 18/09/2026

PUBLIC CAUTION NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the general public, members of the Sangat and all religious/social institutions that the youth wing/group/ kirtan jatha operating under the name and style of **BALA PRITAM BAL SEWAK JATHA / BALA PRITAM JATHA** belongs exclusively, absolutely, and legally to **GURDWARA SRI GURU SINGH SABHA, C-BLOCK, HARI NAGAR, NEW DELHI -110064.**

It is further Notice to the general public, members of the Sangat, and all religious/social institutions that the name, style, and title **"BALA PRITAM "** specifically as used in **"BALA PRITAM BAL SEWAK JATHA / BALA PRITAM JATHA"**---is a unique nomenclature coined, established, and continuously used since long exclusively and absolutely by **GURDWARA SRI GURU SINGH SABHA, C-BLOCK, HARI NAGAR, NEW DELHI 110064.**

It has come to our knowledge that certain unauthorized individuals, dismissed members, or external elements are attempting to operate, organize events, or communicate using the name of **" Bala Pritam"** without our written consent or authorization.

(Gurmeet Singh Garcha)
General Secretary

AXIS BANK LTD. | Axis Bank Ltd., Axis House, Tower T-2, 2nd Floor, I-14, Sector-128, Noida Expressway, Jaypee Greens Wishtown, Noida (U.P.)-201301.

REGISTERED OFFICE : "TRISHUL" – 3RD Floor Opp. Samartheswar Temple, Near Law Garden, Ellisbridge, Ahmedabad – 380006.

APPENDIX IV [Refer Rule – 8(1)] POSSESSION NOTICE (For Immovable Property)

Whereas the undersigned being the Authorized Officer of Axis Bank Ltd. under the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002 and in exercise of the powers conferred under section 13 (12) read with Rule 3 of the Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 issued **demand notice dated 21-May-26** calling upon **Manik Singh, Meharban Singh & Meena Singh (Borrower/Co- Borrower/Mortgagor)** to repay the amount mentioned in the notice being **Rs. 3,37,02,054/-(Rupees Three Crore Thirty Seven Lac Two Thousand Fifty Four Only) as on 16-May-26** and interest and cost thereon within 60 days from the date of receipt of the said notice.
The Borrower(s)/Co-Borrower(s)/Mortgagor(s)/Guarantor(s) above said having failed to repay the amount, notice is hereby given to the Borrower(s)/Co-Borrower(s)/Mortgagor(s)/ Guarantor(s) and the Public in General that the undersigned has taken possession of the property described herein below in exercise of powers conferred on him/her under Section 13 (4) of the said Act read with Rule 8 of Security Interest (Enforcement) Rules, 2002 on **07/10/2026**
The Borrower(s)/Co-Borrower (s)/ Mortgagor(s)/ Guarantor(s) above said in particular and the Public in General is hereby cautioned not to deal with the properties and any dealings with the properties will be subject to the charge of the Axis Bank Ltd. for an amount of **Rs. 3,37,02,054/-(Rupees Three Crore Thirty Seven Lac Two Thousand Fifty Four Only) as on 16-May-26** and together with further interest thereon at the contractual rate of interest till the date of payment & expenses thereon.
The Borrower(s)/Co-Borrower(s)/Mortgagor(s)/Guarantor(s)'s attention is invited to provisions of sub-section (8) of section 13 of the Act, in respect of time available, to redeem the secured assets.

DESCRIPTION OF IMMOVABLE PROPERTY

All that part and parcel of Property bearing: Flat No. B1401, Tower-B, The Amadeus, Plot No. GH-02, Sec-143 Expressway, Noida, **bounded as under: East –** As per Site Plan; **West –** As per Site Plan; **North –** As per Site Plan; **South –** As per Site Plan.
Please note that as mentioned in Sub-Section 13 of Section 13 of the aforesaid Act, you shall not transfer by way of sale, lease or otherwise any of the assets stated under security referred to in this notice without prior written consent of our Bank.

Dated: 07.10.2026, Place: Noida **Sd/-, Authorized Officer, Axis Bank Ltd.**

GIC HOUSING FINANCE LTD.
गृहे सौख्यम् विराजते
REGD. OFFICE : NATIONAL INSURANCE BLDG , 6TH FLOOR 14, JAMSHEDJI TATA ROAD , CHURCH GATE MUMBAI -400020
Telephone No's:- 022-22851766-68, 022-22884985
NOIDA SECTOR 18 AREA OFFICE : Plot No. 104, 105 FIRST FLOUR VISHAL CHAMBER SECTOR 18 NOIDA
PITAMPURA AREA OFFICE : Plot No. C-1,2,3, 511, 5th Floor, PP Tower, Netaji Subhash Place, Pitampura, Delhi-110034
GURGAON BRANCH OFFICE : Unit No.301/302,3rd Floor,MGF Metropolis,M.G.Raod,Gurgaon- 122001 gurgaon@gichfindia.com
MEERUT BRANCH OFFICE 2nd Floor, Darshan Plaza,Samrat Enclave, Garh Road, Meerut Uttar Pradesh - 250004 0121-2602730

Ref:- Demand notice u/s 13 (2) of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of the financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act, 2002.

Sr. No	NAME OF THE BORROWER & CO-BORROWER/LOAN FILE NO./BRANCH NAME	ADDRESS OF THE MORTGAGED PROPERTY	NPA Classification Date	DATE OF ISSUE DEMAND NOTICE	OUTSTANDING DUES (As per Demand Notice) (AMOUNT IN Rs.)
1.	ARVIND TIWARI / HR0750600001376 / PITAMPURA BRANCH	ENTIRE GROUND FLOOR, PLOT NO-3986, SECTOR-49, EXTN-II, SAINIK COLONY, FARIDABAD-121001	29.09.2021	05.10.2026	Rs. 65,68,828
2.	RAVI KUMAR / UP0750600000578 / PITAMPURA BRANCH	Flat No. B. on second floor, built on Plot No. 14,15,16,17,18, & 32,33,34,35,36, Khasra No. 59, ward No. 35, Royal Tower-4, Unione Residency, situated in the area of Village Akbarpur Behrampur, Tehsil & District Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh203207.	29.10.2024	05.10.2026	Rs. 17,17,160
3.	VIVEK V / DL0510610008092 / GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRA NO. 23/04/2, MUSTATIL NO 23 KILLA 4/2, UPPER GROUND FLOOR BACK SIDE, ,Plot No: RZ-81-A, MATIALA EXTN, MATIALA UTTAM NAGAR, Delhi, 110059	11-08-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 11,61,370
4.	DEEPAK RAI / UP0510610002123 / GURGAON BRANCH	KHASRA NO 156A 156B, M.I.G,FLAT No: T-02,Floor No: THIRD,Plot No: C-14 C-15, SAI UPVAN, YUSUFPUR CHAKSHAHBERI, DADRI, Uttar Pradesh,Pin Code: 201301	11-08-2026	03-09-2026	Rs. 13,11,581
5.	Mr. DHEERAJ KUMAR/SHEETAL / UP0610600002265 / MEERUT BRANCH	House Mun No. W-1/ Plot No. 24, Khasra No. 2321 & 2323 Bheem Nagar, Pargana, Tehsil & Distt. Hapur.	30.05.2026	16-07-2026	Rs.11,75,804
6.	UP0210610002476 MANISH MISHRA / NOIDA BRANCH	Khasra No. 151 B, SAI UPWAN, Flat No: A, Floor: SECOND, Plot: A-22-23, Landmark: GAUR AVANUE CITY 1, Village YusufPur Chaksahberi, Gautam Buddha Nagar, Uttar Pradesh, Pin Code 201301	23-09-2026	25-09-2026	Rs. 12,33,846
7.	UP0210610001850 MOHD MAJAR ALAM / NOIDA BRANCH	TOWER NO A-08, Building Name: HABITECH PANCHTATVA, Flat No: 1606, Floor No: SIXTEENT, Plot No: 08A, Street Name No: TECH ZONE-04, NEAR AMRAPALI DREAM VALL, Village : Sarfabad, Taluka: Greater Noida Uttar Pradesh PinCode: 201304,	30-05-2017	30-09-2026	Rs.21,45,083

1. In term of our sanction letter, you all have been sanctioned short term loan for construction/purchased of residential project on the above reffered respective properties. The respective repayment whereof is secured by creating equitable mortgage in favour of us. The said respective loans have been sanctioned vide express covenant on your part to repay the said short term loan promptly as per the terms and conditions incorporated in the saperate loan Agreement executed by you in favour of GIC Housing Finance Ltd., You have avalied and uitilised the said financial assistance, however, the repayment in the said short term loan/s account have been irregular and your account /s have been classified as non performing assets in accordance with the directions / guidelines relating to assets classification issued by National Housing Bank. We upteen times called upon you all and informed you about said outstanding dues, however there is no reply and or compliance on your part. Thus you are commercially insovents.
2. Therefore GIC Housing Finance hereby call upon you all under this service u/s 13(2) of the Securitisation and Reconstruction of Financial Assets and Enforcement of Security Interest Act 2002, to discharge their laibilities to GIC HF Ltd. In full as stated in aforesaid column no 4, within sixty days from the date of publication of this notice together with further interest and penal interest at contractual rate on balance principal outstanding till payment and/or realisation, falling which we shall be free excerise all or any of the rights under section 13(4) of the said act, which please note.
3. You are also put on notice that in terms of sub-section 13 of the said Act, you sale not transfer by way of sale, lease or otherwise the aforesasid secured assets without obtaining written consent from GIC HFL ltd., failing which you will be liable for an offence punishable under section 29 of the said Act, please take further note hereof.
4. This notice is without prejudice to the right of GIC HFL to initiate such other actions or legal proceeding as it deems necessary under any other applicable provision of law. The undersigned is duly authorised officer of GIC HFL to issue this notice and exercise powers under sub section (2) of section 13 of aforesaid Act.

Place: Pitampura, Meerut, Gurgaon
Date: 09-10-2026

Yours Truly,
For GIC Housing Finance Ltd.
sd/- Authorised Officer

SHIPRA NEO APARTMENT OWNERS ASSOCIATION
Dr. Sushila Nayyar Marg, Vaibhav Khand, Indirapuram, Ghaziabad, U.P. - 201014

INVITATION FOR EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)

For Engagement of Security Services Agency

Shipra Neo Apartment Owners Association invites Expressions of Interest (EOI) from reputed, experienced and PSARA licensed security agencies for providing security services at its residential premises, including Security Supervisors, Armed Guards, and Male and Female Security Guards.

Eligibility Criteria:

- Minimum 10 years of experience in providing security services.
- Minimum annual turnover of Rs. 10 crore in each of the last two financial years.
- Valid PSARA licence for Uttar Pradesh.
- Valid GST, PAN, EPF and ESIC registrations.

Interested agencies are requested to submit their company profile, eligibility documents and details of relevant experience by email to **shipraneoboard@outlook.com** on or before **13 October 2026, up to 5:00 PM** (IST).

Shortlisted agencies will be invited to participate in the subsequent Request for Proposal (RFP) / Tender process. Submission of an EOI shall not confer any right to participate in the subsequent tender process or to receive an award of contract. The Association reserves the right to accept or reject any or all EOIs, in accordance with applicable law, its registered bye-laws and the approved tender process.

For Shipra Neo Apartment Owners Association
Authorised Signatory
Management Committee

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-AUCTION NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Commercial Manager/PS, Northern Railway Delhi Division invites bids through e-Auction through IREPS **(http:/ireps.gov.in/)** for the allotment of Deluxe Pay & Use Toilet Contracts on MOT Basis, at following Railway stations/locations:-

E-Catalogue No.	Date & Time of bidding	Railway Stations/Locations/Sites
PaynUse-11-2026	23.10.2026 at 12:00 Hrs.	Hazrat Nizamuddin (NZM) 02 Sites, Delhi (DLI) 01 Site, Anand Vihar (ANVT) 01 Site, SONIPAT (SNP) 01 Site, Modinagar (MDNR) 01 Site, Narwana (NRW) 01 Site, Mansa (MSZ) 01 Site, Delhi Sarai Rohilla (DEE) 01 site, Subzi Mandi (SZM) 01 Site & Panipat (PNP) 01 Site Total 11 Sites.
Website particulars where complete details of E-Auction can be seen		**https://ireps.gov.in/**

All contractors who intend to participate in the e-auctions conducted through E-Auction Leasing module of IREPS should fulfil following mandatory requirements before they can submit their bids:

- Registration on IREPS for E-Auctlon Leasing module
- Active IREPS User Account for E-Auction Leasing Module
- Payment of One Time Registration Fee; Current Account in State Bank of India; Integration of SBI Bank Account with IREPS Account; Lien Marking of Funds; Updation of Turnover Details
- A new mechanism namely Virtual Account Number (VAN) has been introduced now for E-Auction Leasing module, which can be used by the bidders as an alternative to Lien Marking Mechanism. The bidders are free to switch between Lien Marking Mechanism (if activated) and VAN mechanism at any point of time, before entering the bidding room. VAN mechanism does not require the bidder to have a current account in State Bank of India. The users are free to transfer money from any of their existing bank accounts in any bank to their VAN account, which enables them to participate in IREPS E-Auctions.
- Contractors who do not have IREPS account for any module of IREPS can submit their online request for registration by clicking on New Vendors / Contractors (E-Tender/ E-Auction Leasing) link on IREPS Home page.

Railway Authority to contact, in case of any query	Divisional Railway Manager's Office, Commercial Branch, State Entry Road, New Delhi -110055. Email: sanitationcell@gmail.com Tel: 011-23743084

No.: 7PUB/TN/Pay&UseToilets/Auction/2022 Date: 07.10.2026 **3491/2026**

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The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | FRIDAY | OCTOBER 9, 2026

Day 3: Barricades slow central Delhi traffic after Opposition protests

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Traffic in central Delhi was disrupted for a third consecutive day on Thursday. Heavy security deployment, barricading and a series of Delhi Traffic Police advisories accompanied the INDIA bloc's protest against Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar. Commuters were advised to avoid stretches around Rajghat, Kishan Ghat Road and Minto Road, and to use public transport.

Security was tightened from the morning around the Sansad Marg roundabout, the Election Commission office at Nirvachan Sadan and Jantar Mantar. On Thursday, Section 163 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita had been imposed in several parts of the capital. Delhi Police station house officers have been told to track buses headed towards the New Delhi district.

The first disruption came in Connaught Place on the first afternoon. Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge hosted Opposition MPs for lunch at Moets, and the gathering caused a major traffic jam in the area. Police deployed additional personnel in the market. The MPs then left for Rajghat in buses.

At about 1 pm, Delhi Traffic Police warned of possible congestion on Rajghat-Kishan Ghat Road and nearby stretches. The advisory said around 500 to 600 people, led by Delhi Congress president Devender Yadav, were expected to gather at Rajghat and proceed to Kishan Ghat Road for a dharna. Motorists were advised to avoid the area, use alternative routes via JLN Marg, Minto Road and Ajmeri Gate, follow directions from traffic personnel and park only in designated spaces.

A second advisory, posted on X by Delhi Traffic Police, covered JLN Marg, Minto Road and Maharaja Ranjeet Singh Marg. Traffic was likely to be affected between 1.30 pm and 3.30 pm because of a symbolic rally by women students of Zakir Hussain Delhi College. Commuters were asked to avoid the routes and plan journeys.





Traffic congestion at Connaught Place as Congress workers gather after a lunch hosted by party President Mallikarjun Kharge for INDIA bloc leaders, for the second consecutive day in New Delhi on Thursday PANKAJ KUMAR

The MPs arrived at Rajghat in the late afternoon with thousands of supporters walking alongside them. Police personnel had been deployed at the memorial since the afternoon. The sit-in ended after about an hour.

The restrictions follow similar arrangements earlier in the week. On Tuesday, Delhi Traffic Police regulated and diverted traffic from 8 am around Connaught Place, Patel Chowk, Parliament Street, the GPO, Windsor Place, Ashoka Road and Jantar Mantar Road. The advisory asked commuters to avoid unnecessary travel through the area and prefer the Metro. On Wednesday, security stopped MPs' buses on Ashoka Road, about 2 km from Jantar Mantar, and detained 91 people.

Central forces have also been added. The Union Home Ministry has approved 110 additional Central Armed Police Force companies for Delhi from October 8 to 12. That would take the central force presence in the capital to about 26,000 personnel.

More restrictions could follow. The Cockroach Janta Party and student groups have called a "*Delhi Chalo* " protest at Jantar Mantar on October 10.

Fresh FIR filed over July 20 CJP protest violence

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Delhi Police Crime Branch has registered a fresh FIR to investigate the violence that erupted during the Cockroach Janta Party's (CJP) protest in the national capital on July 20, police sources said Thursday. The case, lodged against unidentified persons, will examine whether the clashes were premeditated and will seek to identify those allegedly responsible for assaults on police personnel, vandalism and damage to public property.

The FIR, registered at the Crime Branch headquarters and numbered under the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS), invokes provisions relating to rioting, unlawful assembly, assault or use of criminal force against a public servant, disobedience of lawful orders, obstruction of public servants, criminal conspiracy and damage to public property.

Sources said the complaint was based on statements of injured personnel, CCTV and body-worn camera footage, and reports from local police stations in the New Delhi district. Investigators will also determine whether criminal elements entered the protest sites after CJP called for a march towards Parliament that day.

The development comes two days before another CJP protest announced for Jantar Mantar, this time demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar over alleged irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls. A senior police officer said permission has not been granted for the gathering and that prohibitory orders remain in force in the area.

Following Supreme Court orders, Delhi Police cancelled 17 FIRs filed at several police stations in New Delhi related to the July protest. The Crime Branch is running a separate investigation. Their focus is on how the violence unfolded, who was in charge at the protest site, and identifying people who attacked police or damaged vehicles.

Police said the July 20 violence involved alleged stone-pelting, attempts to breach barricades, and damage to police vehicles and other public property after protesters tried to march from Jantar Mantar towards Parliament. More than a hundred police personnel were reported injured in the broader clashes that followed over subsequent days. Protesters, for their part, alleged that police used excessive force, including lathi charges, to disperse the crowd.

A key strand of the investigation concerns 2,873 people with criminal backgrounds whom police said the Facial Recognition System identified during the protest. The Crime Branch will examine their role, including whether any of them were among those who assaulted officers or vandalised property after the call for the Parliament march. Police also said the facial recognition system's accuracy in this exercise was about 50 per cent. Police would corroborate those matches with other evidence before taking further action.

Sources said investigators have begun gathering video footage from the protest stage, nearby roads, and intersections to piece together when the first clashes began and to identify any speakers or organisers whose comments may have preceded the violence. They will also look into whether the march was organised in a way that expected a confrontation with security forces.

CJP, which describes itself as a satirical online movement that later took to the streets, has previously maintained that its demonstrations were peaceful.

500 women paramilitary personnel deployed amid October 10 protest

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Delhi Police are preparing for a large turnout of women at the October 10 "Jantar Mantar 2.0" protest organised by the Cockroach Janta Party, with officers confirming they will deploy 450 to 500 additional women paramilitary personnel to help manage the expected crowd.

Police sources told The Pioneer that at least five all-women companies from central armed police forces will be stationed with Delhi Police during the protest. These units are part of a larger reinforcement of about 11,000 extra central force personnel coming to the city. With these additions, the total number of Central Armed Police Forces in Delhi is expected to reach around 26,000, the highest since the North East Delhi riots in 2020.

In New Delhi district, where Jantar Mantar is located, about 5,000 Delhi Police officers are already on duty. Officials said the number could rise to 15,000 if the expected crowd grows. Additional women paramilitary personnel will work with Delhi Police women officers to ensure enough female staff for searches, crowd guidance, and handling any incidents involving women.

These preparations are in place because many women are expected to attend the protest. Officials have not given an official estimate of the total turnout. Still, the large police mobilisation suggests they are planning for a big crowd that will need extra security at the protest site and nearby areas. Jantar Mantar has often been used for public demonstrations in Delhi, and past events there have sometimes needed more police when large crowds were expected.

Police have marked the Cockroach Janta Party protest, called "Jantar Mantar 2.0," for special planning because of the expected number of women in the crowd. Police usually use all-women units when female protesters may need to be searched, escorted, or spoken to by women officers. This is standard practice to maintain order and avoid issues. These units will work with mixed teams to handle both general crowd control and tasks that need women officers.

New units will join the central forces already in Delhi, bringing the total number of CAPF personnel to the level seen during the 2020 riots. That earlier deployment was one of the largest peacetime gatherings of paramilitary forces in Delhi in recent years, and officials are using it as a benchmark for the current preparations. Delhi Police still has primary responsibility for the district and can increase its numbers from 5,000 to 15,000 if needed, based on real-time information.

Liquor vends to remain shut on October 9-10 amid protests; bars to stay open

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Delhi Government on Thursday directed the closure of liquor stores in the city on October 9 and 10 due to the "prevailing" situation to maintain public order. An order issued by the Excise Department said the closure of liquor vends was based on inputs from Delhi Police and was a preventive measure to maintain "public order".

"In view of the prevailing situation and inputs received from Delhi Police, as a preventive measure aimed at maintaining public order, it is hereby ordered that all retail liquor vends with licences in Form L6, L6& L6FG, L8, L10 and L8 & L14 operating in Delhi will be completely closed on October 9 and October 10," said the order.

However, hotels, clubs, bars, and restaurants with excise licences to serve liquor will remain open.

The order comes ahead of ongoing protests by opposition parties demanding the resignation of Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar over alleged "vote theft".

A call for protest at Jantar Mantar on October 10 has also been given by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP). Several student and farmer outfits, as well as the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), have decided to join the protest against the CEC.

More than 20,000 police and paramilitary personnel have been deployed across Delhi ahead of the CJP protest, a senior officer said on Thursday.

The officer said no one has been granted permission to protest at Jantar Mantar and appealed to people to avoid participating in any unauthorised gathering.

In view of the protest calls, Delhi Police sources said they are making all preparations to prevent an unprecedented law-and-order situation like the one witnessed during the CJP protest at Jantar Mantar on July 20. "The Delhi Government was requested for closure of liquor shops as a precautionary measure to prevent any untoward incident," said a police source.

The political scenario in the national capital has intensified, with continued protests by the Congress, Left parties and AAP demanding the CEC's resignation.

Large numbers gathered at protests led by opposition leaders over the issue in the past two days. Congress leaders Rahul Gandhi and his sister Priyanka Vadra, along with other MPs, were detained by the police and released on both days.

BJP Mahila Morcha protests over Rahul Gandhi's alleged misbehaviour with women cops

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Delhi BJP Mahila Morcha workers staged a protest near Indira Bhawan, the Congress headquarters on Deen Dayal Upadhyaya Marg, against Congress leader Rahul Gandhi's alleged misbehaviour with women police personnel on Tuesday and Wednesday.

Near Hindi Bhawan, the police formed a heavy human barricade and forcibly stopped the women participating in the protest march. The protesters subsequently staged a sit-in at the spot. After some time, the police warned them and allowed them to leave.

The BJP has accused Rahul Gandhi of "inappropriately touching" a female constable and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra of "punching" a cop during their street protest, and claimed that the action of the Congress leaders was not consistent with their slogan of "smash the patriarchy".

"There is a place for disagreement in a democracy, but raising a hand against women police personnel and insulting them is unacceptable. Every citizen has a duty to respect the uniform. If such anti-women behaviour does not stop, the BJP Mahila Morcha will intensify its agitation on an even larger scale," said Delhi BJP General Secretary Yogita Singh

Mahila Morcha in-charge Aarti Mehra said that someone who cannot respect the uniform that protects women cannot claim to respect the country's women. The Congress party must apologise to the nation. Rahul Gandhi must immediately apologise; otherwise, the women of Delhi will respond to this on the streets."

Rahul Gandhi's misbehaviour with women police personnel is shameful. The Congress has always insulted women. We demand that Rahul Gandhi issue a public apology immediately. The insult to *Nari Shakti* will no longer be tolerated. Rahul Gandhi's misbehaviour with women police personnel reflects the anti-women mindset of the Congress. Insulting the uniform insults the nation. We demand an immediate apology from Rahul Gandhi. The BJP Mahila Morcha said it will remain committed to protecting women's dignity and the self-respect of women police personnel.



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60.86 sq.m. @ ₹33.40 lakhs*

(*Starting price after 25% discount)

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Key Highlights: • Freehold property • No restriction on property ownership - eligible buyers can purchase even if they already own property • Amalgamation of flats allowed with approval • Sample flats available for visit • Completely online scheme

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3 BHK: 164.18 sq.m.** @ ₹106.55 lakhs* flats also available

*Starting price after 25% discount | **Starting area

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- Upcoming Metro Station - 1.2 km
- Upcoming Integrated Sports Stadium - 9.2 km
- Proposed RRTS Station - 1.9 km
- Upcoming Education Hub - 5 km
- Facing Mamurpur Forest
- Lush Green Environment within Pocket-11
- UER-1 - 500 m, UER-2 - 6.15 km
- GT Karnal Road - 1.1 km
- Narela Sports Complex - 2 km

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Dial helpline no. 1800110332

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | FRIDAY | OCTOBER 9, 2026

IN FOCUS



Indian Air Force (IAF) Sarang Helicopter Display Team perform maneuvers during the Exercise Tarang Shakti 2026 at the Air Force Station in Jodhpur on Thursday PTI

Delhi Govt plans to speed up ₹7,000 cr elevated Ring Road

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Delhi Government plans to speed up work on its ambitious ₹7,000-crore elevated Ring Road project after the newly opened Barapullah Phase 3 saw perennial gridlock, officials said on Thursday.

Spanning 55 kilometres, the project includes two new bridges over the Yamuna to improve connectivity between Trans-Yamuna areas and the rest of the city.

"Under long-term measures, our elevated Ring Road project will add two flyovers over the Yamuna River, which will improve traffic management along the area. The detailed project report for the first package is ready and has been approved by the Chief Minister recently," Public Works Department Minister Parvesh Singh Verma said.

Officials said, as part of the plan to decongest Ring Road, the government is working on a new bridge near the existing Signature Bridge, and a second flyover will run from Metcalfe House to the Delhi-Noida-Direct (DND) flyway near Ashram.

Officials said the need for additional capacity has become more pressing with the opening of Barapullah Phase 3. The Ring Road stretch around Sarai Kale Khan, a key link between central Delhi and southeast and east Delhi, has seen rising traffic volumes.

According to the plan, the initial phases, including Azadpur Flyover to Hanuman Temple (ISBT) (9.5 kilometres), Chandgi Ram Akhara to Majnu Ka Tilla (2.5 kilometres) and Hanuman Temple (ISBT) to DND Flyover (11.5 kilometres), will be taken up initially on priority.

After completion, the elevated road will connect to the Azadpur flyover near Mukarba Chowk and the DND road, which further connects to the Ashram flyover, a critical arterial road in South Delhi, officials said.

BJP must sack CEC, says Revanth Reddy

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Hyderabad



Telangana Chief Minister A Revanth Reddy on Thursday alleged that Prime Minister Narendra Modi sought to capture power through "divisive tactics" and said the BJP should either "sack" CEC Gyanesh Kumar or be "consigned to the dustbin" of political history.

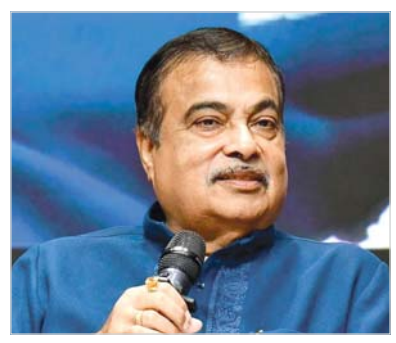
Reddy, who is in Delhi to participate in the protests by Congress and other INDIA bloc parties against SIR, claimed that BJP wanted to take away the voting rights of the poor who have turned against it.

"Prime Minister Narendra Modi has always wanted to capture power using divisive tactics taken from the imperialist British playbook," he said in a statement.

According to him, the BJP has tried to divide Indians on the basis of religion, caste, region and language, and also misused central agencies to threaten the opposition and weaken institutions.

Gadkari sets 10-day deadline for Pondy Road proposals

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ Puducherry



Union Road Transport and Highways Ministry Nitin Gadkari has directed officials of his ministry to examine and approve within 10 days the proposals submitted by Puducherry Chief Minister N Rangasamy, PWD Minister Malladi Krishna Rao said on Thursday.

Rao, who participated in the GST Council meeting in Delhi, said he handed over the letter of the Puducherry CM to Nitin Gadkari seeking sanction of ₹1,500 crore for the extension of the proposed fly over from Puducherry to Mullodai on Puducherry-Cuddalore route.

Rao held a meeting with the Road Transport and National Highways Minister. In a release, he said the Centre had already approved the flyover on the Puducherry-Cuddalore route at a cost of ₹650 crores with the initial proposal to cover only 2.5 km.

The CM has sought to extend the flyover to cover the entire 13.30-km stretch between Puducherry and Mullodai village, Rao said in a release.

This extended flyover would ease traffic congestion on Puducherry — Cuddalore route particularly during weekends. Nitin Gadkari asked officials of his Ministry to consider the representation and accord approval in 10 days, the PWD Minister said.

The union minister also asked the officials to positively consider the request of the CM for sanction of ₹12 crores to improve the road linking the road from Department of Fisheries to National Highways in Yanam (an enclave of Puducherry in Andhra Pradesh), the PWD Minister said.

GST reforms to ease refunds, registration for Delhi businesses

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Thursday said proposed GST reforms would make tax compliance easier for businesses and taxpayers by simplifying registration and automating the refund process.

The Chief Minister participated in the 57th GST Council meeting at Bharat Mandapam and said the measures discussed by the Council would help create a more transparent, efficient and business-friendly tax system. Senior officials from Delhi's Finance and Tax Department were also present at the meeting.

The CM said automation of GST refunds would help businesses receive their money on time. She said faster refunds would also improve the competitiveness of exporters by reducing delays in receiving funds.

For businesses shutting down operations, the Chief Minister said the proposed automated cancellation of GST registration would reduce delays and make the exit process easier for taxpayers. She also highlighted proposed changes to the GST registration system, saying the simplified process would particularly benefit small sellers operating through e-commerce platforms. The changes aim to streamline registration and reduce procedural hurdles for smaller businesses.

The Chief Minister said other proposed measures, including removing the power of arrest under GST and rationalising prosecution provisions, would contribute to a more favourable business environment. The Chief Minister added that the reforms would simplify the GST framework, make it more taxpayer-friendly, and improve the ease of doing business.

The measures are expected to affect businesses and taxpayers at different stages of the GST process, from registration and compliance to refunds and closure of registrations. The Chief Minister said the reforms would make the tax system more responsive to the needs of taxpayers. Welcoming the proposals discussed at the meeting,



she said the reforms aimed to simplify the GST system and make it more convenient for taxpayers.

The Chief Minister also said the changes could boost Delhi's economic activity by creating a more supportive environment for businesses. She expressed hope that the reforms would add dynamism to the capital's economy.

The CM said the proposed changes align with the broader objective of developing a transparent, efficient, and responsive tax regime. She also said the reforms would contribute to the national objective of achieving a developed India by 2047.

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Trump targets Indian IT giants

The action adds to pressure already building on Indian technology companies and their employees. USCIS data for FY2025 showed that 283,772 of 406,348 approved H-1B petitions involved beneficiaries born in India, or nearly 70%. Computer-related occupations accounted for 252,088 approvals, or about 62% of the total.

The Trump administration has also renewed a $100,000 payment requirement for certain new H-1B workers seeking entry to the US from abroad, although the measure is facing legal challenges. A second federal judge blocked the fee on September 30, after an appeals court upheld an earlier ruling.

Under the wage-weighted system introduced for FY2027, higher-paid positions carry more weight in the selection process, increasing the relative advantage of higher-wage workers.

The impact is already visible among major technology services companies. An analysis of USCIS data showed H-1B approvals for six major IT services companies fell about 40% to 11,041 by March 2026, down from about 18,469 a year earlier. The US is also considering an additional $103,265 fee for each cap-subject H-1B petition.

The proposal, which would add to existing charges, has not yet become a permanent requirement.

For Indian IT companies, the cumulative effect could accelerate a shift away from large-scale routine onsite deployment. Firms could rely more on US-based hiring for roles requiring a local presence, expand India-based delivery, and reserve foreign-worker sponsorship for specialised roles in AI, engineering, cloud, data, and cybersecurity.

For Indian professionals already in the US, the immediate impact of the PERM suspension is different from an H-1B restriction. It does not by itself cancel existing H-1B status or employment. But delays or suspension of employer-sponsored labour certification could complicate the longer-term path to permanent residency.

The latest action therefore takes the US immigration crackdown beyond temporary work visas. For Indian IT professionals, the uncertainty is increasingly extending from getting a US work visa to securing a permanent career path in America.

GST Council eases norms, scraps arrest powers

The reform will allow eligible small sellers to operate without establishing a place of business in every state, easing compliance for businesses selling across state borders through online platforms.

Another key recommendation was about extending refunds under the inverted rate structure to input services. The change will apply to credit availed on or after November 1, 2026, Sitharaman said.

The Finance Minister also said that the government intends to introduce faceless tax assessment for Central Goods and Services Tax (CGST) taxpayers registered in multiple States.

The minister said the government approved a concept note proposing a single window for scrutiny of returns, audits, adjudications, appeals, taxpayer services, and grievance redressal for CGST taxpayers. Sitharaman said the framework for faceless assessment for CGST taxpayers will be put up for consultation and will be implemented from the next fiscal year, 2027-28.

Replying to a query, Sitharaman said the GST Council had mostly addressed the aberrations due to ITC and the duty inversion. So, I don't think many outstanding issues remain that are fundamental to ease of doing business, or that involve anomalies and rates. So, yes, you can say GST next generation GST, 99 per cent issues have been addressed, rate or process," Sitharaman said.

The GST reform Process has been driven from the principle of trust, the Minister said.

"Business has to be trusted. Taxpayers have to be trusted. And businesses among themselves, with trust, if they do it, we shouldn't be too intrusive," she added.

Clarifying speculation around the Merchant Discount Rate (MDR), Sitharaman said the 57th GST Council meeting did not discuss MDR.

Another key recommendation of the Council was to make input tax credit available on health and life insurance taken for employees. The credit will also be available on telecommunication towers and on pipelines laid outside a factory, both of which are large items for those sectors.

The Council also recommended input credit for free samples and for stock written off at the expiry of shelf life, where the law requires the goods to be destroyed.

Day 3: INDIA bloc takes protest to Rajghat

Kharge said the protest was peaceful and that the MPs went to pray for the Government's good sense. He said vote theft should stop, those responsible for mistakes should resign, and citizens' right to vote should be protected.

Rahul Gandhi told reporters that about 300 MPs had wanted to hold a peaceful sit-in, but were stopped near the Election Commission of India office on the first day and kept from Jantar Mantar on the second. He alleged that people were beaten. He also accused Prime Minister Narendra Modi, Home Minister Amit Shah, RSS chief Mohan Bhagwat and Kumar of taking the country over through a criminal conspiracy. These are allegations made at the protest. The BJP has rejected the Opposition's charges.

The street protests have been marked by police action. On Tuesday, MPs marched from Parliament towards the Election Commission headquarters and held an eight-hour sit-in at Akashvani Bhawan. Police said they detained nearly 250 people, including Rahul and Priyanka Gandhi. On Wednesday, the MPs' buses were stopped on Ashoka Road, about 2 km from Jantar Mantar.

Delhi Police have registered at least three FIRs against the Gandhis. One relates to entering Akashvani Bhawan without permission. Others allege assault on police personnel and obstruction of government work during Wednesday's protest. BJP spokespersons have alleged that Rahul Gandhi pushed a woman officer and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra elbowed another. The Congress leaders have not accepted the charges, and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra alleged police manhandling.

In Bengaluru, the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) held a "people's tribunal" and a protest at Freedom Park. CJP founder Abhijeet Dipke, YouTuber Dhruv Rathee and actor Prakash Raj attended. Dipke alleged that voter deletions under the SIR aimed to disenfranchise those opposed to the BJP and said the agitation would continue until Kumar resigns. Rathee demanded the CEC's resignation, saying the commission lacked transparency and accountability. Prakash Raj called for the SIR to be scrapped.

The CJP and student groups have called a "Delhi Chalo" protest at Jantar Mantar on October 10. The Home Ministry has approved 110 additional Central Armed Police Force companies for Delhi from October 8 to 12. The Delhi Excise Department has ordered liquor shops across the capital shut on October 9 and 10 as a precaution. The order covers L6, L6FG, L8, L10, L14 and combined L8 and L14 licences. Opposition leaders are likely to meet at Parliament House on Friday morning to decide the next step.

Digital India plugged welfare leakages: PM

As regards direct benefit transfers using technology, Modi said, "And through this, nearly 5 lakh crore rupees...this is not a small number...5 lakh crore rupees have been saved from going into the wrong hands. Now tell me, those whose ill-gotten income has stopped, will they love Modi? Did I do the right thing? Should it be done or not? Should all these wrong practices be stopped? The Prime Minister stressed, "No matter how much they shout or scream, I am determined to get it done," he said.

He observed that had the old system prevailed, ₹5 lakh crore of the Government would have gone into leakages, filling the pockets of such people. "Modi has stopped this," he said, adding that the money now reaches rightful beneficiaries and is used for the right causes.

Under the PM-KISAN Samman Nidhi, the PM said more than ₹4 lakh crore has been deposited into farmers' bank accounts. The amount is disbursed every four months, and farmers receive the message on their mobile phones, he said.

The prime minister also said India has moved from being a consumer to a creator in the telecom sector and is advancing toward designing products and owning technology and intellectual property in the country.

He said the 'Reform Express' was moving rapidly in the telecom sector, modernising decades-old laws and creating a modern regulatory framework through the Telecommunications Act.

On cross-border cyber fraud, Modi warned that such crimes do not respect borders and asserted that technology scales only when it earns trust.

Highlighting the cross-border nature of cybercrimes, he said a person sitting in one country, with the help of another country, can commit a crime in a third country.

"We are also seeing what a big challenge deep fakes have become," Modi said, adding that countries need to work together on a global framework to address such emerging threats.

"Therefore, it is necessary that we work on a global framework for this. Governments, technology companies, telecom operators, and financial institutions will all need to connect to this framework. I urge the GSMA and telecom operators across the world: come, let us create a global mechanism that can stop such fraud before it reaches the people," Modi said.

Industry body GSMA represents mobile network operators and companies across the global ecosystem.

Modi said strengthening the security framework around telecom and digital technologies was equally crucial for their rapid expansion, with phone and network security becoming priorities. Communications Minister Jyotiraditya Scindia, Bharti Group Chairman Sunil Bharti Mittal, Reliance Jio Infocomm Chairman Akash Ambani and Aditya Birla Group Chairman Kumar Mangalam Birla were among those present at the inaugural session of IMC 2026.

Organised jointly by the Department of Telecommunications (DoT) and the Cellular Operators Association of India (COAI), IMC 2026 centres on the theme 'Scale Without Boundaries', highlighting India's growing mettle in digital innovation, next-generation connectivity and technology-led growth.

The event focuses on next-generation digital infrastructure, technology-led economic growth, and inclusive digital access and secure ecosystems. It brings together global technology leaders, policymakers, industry experts, startups, investors and innovators to discuss emerging opportunities across the digital ecosystem.

Musk cries oligarchs; Gandhi says, wait...

A post Musk replied to earlier this week cited more than 11,000 listed villages still without 4G coverage as of May. Musk has argued that Starlink would offer high-speed links to people who cannot afford current prices or who have no connection at all. He has also dismissed claims that Starlink terminals were used by militants in Manipur, writing that beams are switched off over India and therefore could not have been used for any purpose there.

Others in the room were careful. Bharti Airtel chairman Sunil Bharti Mittal, whose group backs OneWeb, said his satellite venture was awaiting approvals. Jio Platforms managing director Akash Ambani declined to comment, saying he had not seen Musk's remarks. Neither company joined the argument in public.

SpaceX, for its part, says the hardware is already in place. Lauren Dreyer, vice-president for Starlink business operations, told Congress that the company has built 20 gateway sites in India, installed hundreds of antennas, and set controls to keep Indian user data in the country. Starlink's case is that five years of compliance, a licence and ground equipment should now produce a commercial green light.

Under Government rules, a licenced operator can move forward with spectrum assignment only after completing the security process. Once all three licensees complete this step, those waiting in the satellite queue can start paid service. The ministry says the queue is shared, but Musk has said twice in two days, and again in a personal note, that the wait is not neutral.

From Darr to Dhanda, Nana Patekar's...

The prime minister added that Patekar was also admired for his frank, forthright views and never hesitated to express what he believed.

"Shri Nana Patekar's contribution to Hindi and Marathi cinema was immense. His passing leaves a deep void-my condolences to his family, friends and countless admirers. Om Shanti," he said.

Later, Modi paid tributes to the actor while inaugurating the 10th edition of the India Mobile Congress (IMC) 2026 here.

"We received news in the morning that renowned actor Nana Patekar is no longer with us. He was a versatile actor who won people's hearts through different characters," he said. Patekar's life was dedicated to the glory of the tricolour, and he was never confined to any bindings, he said. The actor used to fly like a bird in the world of films. Through films, he strongly attacked the evils prevalent in society, he said. "He was such a revolutionary that he worked against social evils," Modi said.

Patekar's powerful dialogues and silence were equally impactful, and he always favoured taking strong action against anti-nationals, the PM said. "I pay my respects to his family, friends and admirers," he said.

Patekar, known for his versatility and powerful screen presence, played memorable roles in several Hindi and Marathi films.

His notable Hindi movies include "Parinda", "Prahaar: The Final Act", "Tirangaa", "Krantiveer" and "Khamoshi: The Musical". Patekar received three National Film Awards, several Filmfare Awards, the Maharashtra State Film Award, and Filmfare Awards Marathi. He had also received Padma Shri, the country's fourth-highest civilian honour.

He was born Vishwanath Patekar in Murud-Janjira, Raigad district, as the youngest of three brothers. He broke out in theatre with Vijaya Mehta's "Hamidabai Chi Kothi", which led to more acclaimed stage performances.

In interviews, Patekar often credited the late Smita Patil for convincing him to try movies. Patekar said he hesitated because he felt his dark complexion would lead to rejection.

The big screen debut came in 1978 with Muzaffar Ali's "Gaman", which had Patil and Farookh Sheikh in lead roles. It led to movies such as "Sinhaasan", "Sinhaasan", "Giddh", "Aaj Ki Awaz", "Ankush" and "Pratighaat".

Ten years later, Mira Nair's 1988 film "Salaam Bombay!" saw him play a local thug and drug dealer. The role in the Oscar-nominated film put him on the map and propelled him into the big league of critically acclaimed actors.

In 1990, Vidhu Vinod Chopra cast him as Anna, the central villain in his acclaimed "Parinda". The role, still remembered for its quiet menace, won him his first of three National Awards.

He won his second National Film Award, this time as lead actor, for his role in the 1994 hit "Krantiveer" as the wayward son of a freedom fighter who transforms and fights for the rights of people with low incomes.

The roles he played were as varied as possible, be it Prakash Jha's "Apaharan" and "Rajneeti", Marathi film "Natsamrat", the comedic "Welcome" and "Welcome Back", Tamil hit "Kaala", Sanjay Leela Bhansali's debut "Khamoshi: The Musical", Gulzar's "Hu Tu Tu" or Ram Gopal Varma's "Bhoot".

POWERING DELHI'S FUTURE: TRANSFORMING ROOFTOPS INTO CLEAN ENERGY HUBS



How the Delhi Government and Central Initiative are Making Solar Adoption Seamless and Accessible for Every Household

Self-reliance in the energy sector, the promotion of clean energy, and environmental protection are vital for India's contemporary development. In alignment with this comprehensive vision, the 'Pradhan Mantri Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana', launched under the leadership of Prime Minister Narendra Modi, is encouraging crores of families across the nation to adopt rooftop solar.

Launched in February 2024, this central scheme aims to install rooftop solar systems on the homes of one crore families nationwide. Under this scheme, assistance is being provided to eligible families to make up to 300 units of electricity free every month. The broader vision behind this initiative by PM Modi is not merely to reduce electricity bills, but to transform households into active participants in energy production and strengthen India in the renewable energy sector.

YOUR ROOFTOP, YOUR ELECTRICITY

In a metropolis such as Delhi, where a large number of families live in independent houses, flats, and residential complexes, rooftop solar is emerging as a vital alternative. Electricity can be generated directly on the home rooftop through solar panels. This helps reduce dependence on traditional electricity sources and allows families to increase the share of clean energy in their energy consumption.

Carrying forward the visionary outlook of PM Modi, the Delhi Government under the able leadership of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta has taken significant steps to implement the 'Pradhan Mantri Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana'. The resolve expressed by the PM to make the common family of the country not just an electricity consumer, but a partner in energy production, is being taken to every household in the capital.

KEY FEATURES & FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE STRUCTURE OF THE SCHEME

FACILITY / SUBJECT	Details and Provisions
CENTRAL FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE	Up to Rs 78,000 assistance provided by the Central Govt for systems up to 3 kW (Up to 2 kW @ Rs 30,000/kW, and an addl Rs 18,000 for the 3rd kW). (Note: Includes provisions up to Rs 18,000/kW for Group Housing Societies up to 3 kW per house and area load including EV connections up to a max limit of 500 kW, as specified in variant documents).
DELHI GOVERNMENT'S ADDITIONAL SUPPORT	**The Delhi Government is providing additional capital subsidy of up to Rs 78,000 along with a top-up for tender price gaps for eligible consumers consuming an average of up to 400 units monthly in FY 2025–26. (Note: Includes up to Rs 11,000/ kW for GHS and EV loads up to 500 kW in specific versions).**
ZERO UPFRONT COST SOLAR	Rooftop solar systems up to 3 kW are available with zero upfront cost for families with an average monthly consumption of up to 400 units in the financial year 2025–26.
FREE MAINTENANCE	**Operation and Maintenance (O&M) of the solar system will be handled free of cost by the concerned vendor for the first 5 years.**
FASTER NET METERING	The net metering process has been reduced from 75 days to just 25 days.
ABOLITION OF REGISTRATION FEES	**Application and registration fees for residential solar systems up to 10 kW have been completely waived.**

> India's growth in the solar sector is the result of a clear approach. Whether in India or in the world, the mantra to increase solar adoption is awareness, availability and affordability.
>
> –NARENDRA MODI
> PRIME MINISTER



Maximising Benefits: Delhi's Unique Add-On Support

The Delhi Government has supplemented central assistance with its own capital subsidy framework to make rooftop solar adoption even simpler and more attractive for Delhi residents. Under the new policy, eligible domestic consumers with an average monthly electricity consumption of up to 400 units in FY 2025–26 will be provided with a rooftop solar system of up to 3 kilowatts with zero upfront cost, subject to technical feasibility. For this:

- Central Assistance: Under the 'PM Surya Ghar Yojana', financial assistance of up to Rs 78,000 is available from the Central Government for rooftop solar systems up to 3 kW.
- State Subsidy: The Delhi Government is also providing a capital subsidy of up to Rs 78,000.
- Additional Top-Up: Furthermore, if there is a gap between the tender-determined cost of the solar plant and the available subsidies, the Delhi Govt will bridge that gap via a top-up for consumers consuming an average of up to 400 units per month.



From Power Consumers to Power Producers

Delhi's consumers will no longer just consume electricity; with Central Assistance and Delhi's additional support, they can also become solar power producers

A 3kW solar system can generate approximately 300 units of electricity. Consequently, if a family's monthly consumption is 200 units, the surplus electricity generated from the system can be fed back into the grid for benefits. According to scheme provisions, payment for the electricity fed into the grid will be made in accordance with the Discom's Average Power Purchase Cost (APVC). Thus, rooftop solar becomes a medium not just for saving on bills, but for active household participation in energy production.

Subsidies Continued, Savings Amplified Through Solar

Delhi's existing electricity subsidy scheme will continue for eligible consumers. This means eligible families receive:

- The benefit of regular electricity subsidies
- Power generation from rooftop solar
- The benefits of net metering

Specifically, for consumers consuming up to 200 units of electricity, an Energy Saving Incentive (e.g., Rs 3 per unit saved) is also provided based on the electricity saved following solar system installation. This paves the way for simultaneously enjoying free/subsidized electricity and clean energy production.



Delhi is Becoming 'Solar-Ready'

The Government of Delhi has made all information, applications, subsidies, and related facilities for rooftop solar accessible on a single digital platform via the Delhi Solar Portal.

Currently, the first phase of the Delhi Solar Scheme targets benefiting 2.20 lakh eligible consumers. So far, more than 50,000 applications have already been registered on the portal.

Citizens can apply via the national portal for the 'PM Surya Ghar Yojana'.

In the national capital, eligible consumers must select an empanelled vendor listed on the PM Surya Ghar portal to claim central subsidies.



Prime Minister Narendra Modi presented the vision of engaging common families in the energy transition through PM Surya Ghar: Muft Bijli Yojana.

Under the leadership of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, the Delhi Government is advancing this vision in alignment with the capital's unique requirements. Combined with central financial assistance, the Delhi Government's additional capital subsidy, zero-upfront-cost options, fast-tracked net metering, and maintenance support share a unified goal: making solar energy accessible to every eligible family in Delhi.

The Delhi Government expresses its deep gratitude for this comprehensive vision of Prime Minister Narendra Modi and resolves to continuously push forward in transforming Delhi into a greener, energy-efficient capital through clean energy, public participation, and modern technology.



Zero Maintenance Worries with Guaranteed Support for Five Years

To ensure families have no anxiety regarding the maintenance of their solar systems post-installation, provisions have been made in the new framework. The vendor associated with the installation will operate and maintain the system free of cost for the first five years. Afterward, consumers can choose to continue maintenance and insurance coverage for up to 25 years through the DISCOMs. Thus, alongside installation, long-term smooth operation has been fully accounted for.

NET METERING NOW FASTER THAN EVER

Another critical change has been introduced for those adopting rooftop solar:

- The net metering process, which previously took approximately 75 days, has been slashed to just **25 days**.
- Additionally, application and registration fees for residential solar systems up to **10 kW** have been waived.

The government's objective is clear:

- Minimised paperwork
- Shorter waiting times
- Seamless applications
- Rapid solar connections

NEW PATHWAYS TO SOLAR ADOPTION

The Delhi Government has emphasized promoting solar energy not merely as a subsidy scheme, but as a comprehensive energy transition. Through the Delhi Solar Portal, citizens are offered diverse models tailored to their needs and economic capacity, including CAPEX, RESCO, Hybrid RESCO, Community Solar, and Group Net Metering.

- Have a roof? Install solar.
- Living in an RWA? Adopt solar for common facilities and EV charging.

The objective is not just placing panels, but making solar adoption accessible to every stratum of society.

PIONEERING TOTAL ENERGY SELF-RELIANCE

In a city where electricity demand is continuously rising, converting home rooftops into electricity generation sources is a step that seamlessly merges energy security, clean energy, and environmental sustainability.

The vision of the Delhi Solar Policy is to make solar energy accessible and affordable for all consumers in Delhi while promoting green jobs. Key objectives include reducing reliance on traditional fossil fuels, fight against air pollution and climate change, and positioning Delhi as a leader in solar adoption.

BUILDING A SOLAR CAPITAL

Under the leadership of Chief Minister Rekha Gupta, the Delhi Government's objective is to expand solar energy beyond government buildings to homes, Resident Welfare Associations (RWAs), Group Housing Societies, and other suitable premises.

Every suitable rooftop in Delhi is a prospective energy source. This vision can lead Delhi toward a capital where:

- Rooftops do not just offer shade; they generate energy.
- Homes do not just consume electricity; they produce it.
- Delhi is not merely an energy-consuming capital, but plays a leading role in clean energy production.

TARGETING 2.30 LAKH ROOFTOPS BY MARCH 2027

The Government of Delhi has set a clear goal for this campaign:

- **To install rooftop solar systems on 2.30 lakh homes by March 2027.**
- **To add more than 500 MW of additional rooftop solar capacity across Delhi.**

The goal is not simply to reach a few thousand homes, but to transform Delhi's rooftops into a vast network of solar energy producers, driving clean power generation at scale across the city.

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Editor's TAKE

Gaza demands more than a ceasefire

Three years after the October 7 massacre, the last Israeli hostage is home, but Gaza lies devastated, while the region remains scarred and its future uncertain

Three years ago, on October 7, 2023, when Hamas-led gunmen killed about 1,200 Israelis and took 251 hostages, the massacre changed the politics of the region. That massacre was a crime, and no grievance excuses it. For the first time, no Israeli hostage remains in Gaza on this anniversary. But what followed was not justice. It was the near-annihilation of Gaza and its people.

The numbers are hard to hold in the mind. Roughly 74,000 Palestinians have been killed, according to Gaza's health ministry. About 80 per cent of structures are damaged. Most of the enclave's two million-plus residents have been displaced and squeezed into less than half the Strip. A UN commission of inquiry has found that acts of genocide were committed.

Fewer than half of Gaza's health facilities function even partially, and the World Health Organization says none has been restored to full capacity since the ceasefire. That ceasefire, imposed last October under Donald Trump's 20-point plan, has stopped the big offensives, not the dying.

The ministry counts 1,467 deaths since it began. The International Stabilisation Force has yet to deploy. The Palestinian technocratic committee meant to run Gaza has not taken charge. Israel says its troops hold about 64 per cent of the territory, and humanitarian access remains tightly restricted. The war did not stay in Gaza. It has spread to Lebanon, Syria and a wider confrontation with Iran that still grinds on, rattling energy markets and fuelling global anger at Israel.

Meanwhile, world attention has drifted, and with it the pressure that forced the truce. The real test comes after Israel's election, when the ceasefire's next phase will either move or quietly die. Gaza desperately needs help, not just help but a complete plan to reconstruct and rehabilitate the people who have endured a lot in the last three years.

The way forward is not mysterious, only unglamorous. Deploy the stabilisation force. Put Gaza's administration in Palestinian technocratic hands. Open the crossings fully and fund reconstruction at scale, not at leisure. Sequence Hamas's disarmament with Israeli withdrawal. Above all, restore a political horizon: without a credible path to Palestinian statehood, every ceasefire is an intermission. And accountability must cut both ways, for the October 7 atrocities and for Gaza's destruction.

India has real stakes in West Asia: millions of citizens working in the Gulf, its energy supply and the IMEC corridor, which needs a calm region. New Delhi formally backs a two-state solution and welcomed the Trump plan.

But friendship with Israel does not require silence on Gaza. New Delhi has access in Jerusalem that few capitals enjoy. It should use it to press for unhindered aid, an end to strikes and a political track, and offer the reconstruction help it can afford. A civilisational power cannot be seen to grieve for only one side.

The new-age policing: Smarter, faster, more humane

In a fast-changing world, police performance will be judged not by the number of tech-based applications launched, but by the number of crimes that do not take place



AJAY SINGHAL



In the 1990s, when I first walked into a police station as a trainee IPS officer, policing was largely a race to catch up with crime. The tools were modest: a handwritten 'Rojnamcha', a temperamental black rotary-dial telephone, and the institutional memory of the MHC and beat constable. Success was measured by how quickly the police reached the scene, arrested the accused and restored order.

Three decades later, that paradigm is changing fundamentally. Technology, data and intelligence are enabling the police to move from reacting to crime to anticipating and preventing it. The critical question is no longer merely, "What happened?" but "What is likely to happen - and what can we do before it does?"

This is the essence of new-age policing: using technology not as an end in itself, but as an instrument to prevent crime, accelerate justice, protect the vulnerable and make policing more accessible, accountable and humane. In Haryana, this transformation is already visible - from Dial 112 and women's safety initiatives to cybercrime intervention, AI-assisted investigation, digital evidence and real-time intelligence. Based on more than five million calls each year, the average response time stays below seven minutes, whether in cities or the countryside. Motorbikes can navigate market streets where four-wheelers would get stuck.

When a woman is in danger, she presses one button on the Durga Shakti app, and her current location is sent to the same command centre. A woman who is travelling alone at night can register her journey and be effectively looked after until she gets home. This is not a reactive action; it is accompaniment.

The previous system largely failed to cope with cybercrime because criminals could be based in another country and money could vanish within minutes. The helpline 1930, connected to Dial 112 and manned by bank representatives who work with police officers, gets about 5,000 calls every day and freezes suspicious transfers before mule accounts can drain them.

Haryana leads the nation in preventing fraudulent transfers and has recovered about 40 per cent of funds defrauded within the state. Since June, any complaint (online) involving a loss of more than ₹1 lakh has automatically resulted in an e-Zero FIR. Prevention is now taking steps even further upstream; the 'Abhedya' app enables unknown international extortion calls to be kept from reaching the victim, and the Dual OTP pilot allows a trusted contact of a senior citizen to block a suspicious large transaction, providing a small amount of protection against the 'digital arrest' scam. The basic beat has also been reconsidered. With the Eagle app, an on-duty police officer can immediately compare a detainee's face with a database of offenders, exposing impersonators and avoiding lengthy detentions for law-abiding citizens. The National Automated Fingerprint Identification System (NAFIS) can match a blurred fingerprint recovered at a crime scene with entries in the national records in just a few seconds. Smart E-Beat records patrols using GPS, and the Crime and Criminal Tracking Network and System (CCTNS) links police stations to courts, jails and forensic facilities. Meanwhile, e-Sakshya ensures that crime-scene evidence is preserved in an unchangeable form.

> THE ULTIMATE TEST, HOWEVER, IS NOT THE NUMBER OF APPS LAUNCHED OR DATABASES CREATED. IT IS MUCH SIMPLER: HOW MANY CRIMES ARE PREVENTED, HOW MANY VICTIMS ARE PROTECTED, HOW QUICKLY JUSTICE IS DELIVERED, AND HOW MUCH PUBLIC TRUST THE POLICE EARN

The reforms go beyond the streets to affect the fundamental machinery of the justice system. When evidence parcels move from the police station to the forensic laboratory, a barcode is assigned to each one, creating a chain of custody that can withstand judicial scrutiny. Instead of making long, risky journeys, prisoners now attend court through secure video links.

Even people with no name are now being given one: an AI-assisted system matches the faces and fingerprints of unidentified bodies with those in the missing persons database, giving closure to families who have been waiting for years. Similarly, internal tools matter; complaint dashboards show where complaints go unaddressed, so accountability does not rely entirely on goodwill.

Crash data is converted into heat maps that show engineers where to redesign a curve, and cashless trauma care helps shorten the important golden hour. On motorways, number-plate recognition cameras continuously monitor the situation and also serve as a record for tracking vehicles that escape.

If we discuss only the possible outcomes of this transformation without going further, we would be poor guardians of it. The United States' experience with statistics-based policing - especially its use of dashboards, performance targets and strict enforcement of minor offences — shows that crime statistics can decrease even as community confidence falls.

Facial recognition, currently being developed to identify offenders who have admitted guilt and those who have jumped bail, and lawful interception can result in excessive surveillance unless strict legal safeguards, regular auditing and proper oversight are in place.

That is the reason why the key improvement does not lie in the server room: just as important as any software are training in de-escalation, awareness of bias and courtesy. Digital services matter too, because the 'HARSAMAY' portal lets citizens avoid queuing for a copy of an FIR or a verification certificate, and QR-code feedback at station counters gives each visitor a chance to share their views. By conducting online patrols and maintaining a visible presence on social media platforms, the community extends its area of responsibility into the digital environment.

"New Age Policing": In the fast-changing world, the performance will be judged not by the number of tech-based applications we launch, but by the number of crimes that do not take place, the number of people who are not harmed, and the citizens who do not even need to go into a police station for an FIR (now e-FIR/Zero FIR beyond jurisdiction).

The ultimate test, however, is not the number of apps launched or databases created. It is much simpler: How many crimes are prevented, how many victims are protected, how quickly justice is delivered, and how much public trust the police earn.

The writer is the Director General of Police, Haryana.

What patience teaches us about progress



SIDDHARTH ROY

2ND OPINION

Concrete offers an unfashionable lesson to a civilisation addicted to speed: strength takes time. A freshly poured slab may look complete, but its real transformation has only begun. Cement reacts with water, particles bind, moisture is retained, and strength develops gradually. Engineers therefore do not simply pour concrete and walk away. They cure it, protect it and allow it to mature. What appears to be waiting is, in fact, part of construction.

Modern life has increasingly treated time as an obstacle. We want instant communication, instant delivery, instant profits and instant transformation. Governments announce targets with compressed timelines; businesses chase quarterly results; individuals measure progress through immediate outcomes. Speed can certainly improve efficiency. But efficiency becomes dangerous when it is confused with haste. Some structures, whether physical or social, cannot be rushed without weakening what they are meant to sustain.

Curing is a useful metaphor for public policy. A bridge cannot be made safe merely by completing its visible structure. Its foundations, joints, materials and load-bearing elements must perform together over time. Similarly, a new law, institution or economic reform requires testing, adjustment and public acceptance. A policy may be announced in a day, but its consequences can take years to reveal themselves. The impatience to demonstrate results can encourage governments to privilege what is measurable immediately over what becomes valuable eventually.

The same principle applies to cities. Roads can be widened quickly, buildings can rise rapidly and new infrastructure can be inaugurated on schedule. Yet urban resilience depends on things less visible: drainage capacity, maintenance systems, open spaces, ecological buffers and institutional coordination. These cannot be improvised after a crisis. They require patient investment before the crisis arrives. The absence of visible progress does not mean the absence of progress.

There is also a personal lesson. Education, expertise, trust and character resemble concrete more than software. They cannot simply be downloaded. A student needs years of reading and failure; a professional needs experience; trust requires repeated proof. Attempts to accelerate these processes may produce impressive appearances without corresponding depth.

Patience, however, should not become an excuse for inefficiency. Concrete is cured according to scientific requirements, not left indefinitely. Good engineering is not slow for the sake of being slow; it is deliberate where time affects performance. The wisdom lies in knowing what can be accelerated and what cannot.

Perhaps modern society needs this distinction more urgently than ever. We have become remarkably good at reducing waiting, but less skilled at understanding its purpose. Yet some forms of waiting are productive. They allow systems to settle, weaknesses to emerge and strength to develop.

Engineers know that a structure designed only for immediate performance may fail under tomorrow's load. The same is true of societies. Sustainable progress is not always the fastest progress. Sometimes, the most responsible thing we can do is build carefully, protect what is still developing, and give true strength the one resource no technology can manufacture: time, patience, discipline, attention, humility and care.

The writer, a civil engineer, is a consultant at Rashtriya Raksha University under the Ministry of Home Affairs

Daiv Vani

WISDOM FOR A MEANINGFUL LIFE

Running in Torn Spikes

Resources can be borrowed or bought, but the belief to keep running has to be built from within.

Gurvindervir Singh, a 25-year-old sprinter from Patial village near Bhogpur in Punjab, won bronze in the 100 metres at the Asian Games in Nagoya. For two to three years he trained in torn spike shoes because his family could not afford new ones. He was told Indians were not suited to the 100 metres, and even his father suggested he change events. He did not. He went on to become the first Indian to run under 10.10 seconds, clocking 10.09 at the Federation Cup in Ranchi. After he shared his struggles on social media, support came from people around the world.

Asked why he never changed his event, he said, "My coaches never told me that it was not possible, then why should I change my event?" The Mahabharata gives us Ekalavya, a young archer turned away from Drona's school, who practised alone before a clay image of the teacher and mastered the art with almost nothing. His story ended unjustly, with his thumb demanded as an offering. Gurvinder's story carries a gentler ending: coaches who believed in him, and a country that finally noticed.

We often postpone our efforts until the right equipment, circumstance or approval arrives, and in waiting we lose years. Today, begin one worthwhile task with exactly what you have, and trust the effort to attract the help it needs.

–DAIV

PIC TALK



Indian Air Force (IAF) Surya Kiran Aerobatic Team aircraft perform manoeuvre during the Exercise Tarang Shakti 2026 in Jodhpur PHOTO: PTI

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Higher rates squeeze household budgets

Apropos, "RBI raises rate, loans get costlier", Oct 8. The Reserve Bank of India's decision to raise the repo rate by 25 basis points to 5.5 per cent comes as a crushing blow to middle-class households across the nation. While the central bank's intent to curb inflation is understandable, this upward revision will directly translate into higher Equated Monthly Instalments (EMIs) for housing, personal and educational loans, placing an immense burden on retail borrowers.For ordinary citizens, the timing could not be worse. Families are already wrestling with severe financial distress caused by the relentlessly rising prices of essential commodities, daily food items and healthcare services. Coupled with stagnant salaries and negligible income growth in recent years, this additional interest burden will severely squeeze already tight monthly household budgets, leaving virtually no room for savings or discretionary spending.

An increased EMI burden will force vulnerable families to make painful compromises on basic living standards or risk falling into debt traps. The RBI and the government must introduce targeted relief measures or capped loan resets to protect fixed-income borrowers.

N SADHASIVA REDDY | BENGALURU

Detention raises questions over dialogue

Apropos of the first-page story, "Day of detention ends with Rahul, Priyanka release at night" (The Pioneer, October 7), the detention of Opposition leaders raises serious questions about the space for dialogue. Hundreds of MPs staged a protest march to the Election Commission of India office to present their grievances concerning the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) exercise. Instead of avoiding engagement, the Election Commission should address the questions raised by opposition parties with clarity, logic and constitutional propriety.

Erecting barricades and making elaborate security arrangements against elected representatives, followed by the detention of lawmakers in large numbers, does little to strengthen confidence in democratic institutions. The concerns raised by the Opposition deserve a response rather than silence.

The political situation has changed. There was a time when the ruling establishment set the narrative, while the Opposition reacted. Today, the Opposition is raising issues that demand answers from those in power.

Leadership requires listening, accountability and the ability to address questions. As John C Maxwell observed, "A leader is one who knows the way, goes the way, and shows the way."

PK SHARMA | PUNJAB

Peaceful protest deserves space

The proposed protest at Jantar Mantar on October 10 raises important questions about the right to peaceful assembly and democratic participation. While Delhi Police has been informed about the protest, representatives of student organisations and the Cockroach Janata Party have said they will not wait for "permission" and that informing the police should be sufficient for necessary law-and-order and traffic arrangements.

The protesters have stated that the agitation will not be limited to demanding the resignation of the Chief Election Commissioner, Gyanesh Kumar. They are also seeking repeal of the 2023 law governing the appointment of election commissioners and reforms to the electoral system. If the protest remains peaceful, authorities should facilitate the exercise of citizens' constitutional rights while ensuring public safety and traffic management. The stated participation of young people from across the country, including members of the INDIA bloc, makes it important that their concerns are heard through lawful and peaceful means.

Dialogue and accommodation are preferable to confrontation. Democratic institutions are strengthened when citizens can express their concerns and grievances without fear.

BHAGWAN THADANI | MUMBAI

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | FRIDAY | OCTOBER 9, 2026

India's AI opportunity lies beyond the race for bigger models

A child learns to recognise a chair from a handful of examples; today's most advanced AI systems require enormous computing power to achieve comparable generalisation. India should compete in the AI race, but also ask the deeper question: what does the 20-watt human brain know that our machines do not?



REPRESENTATIONAL IMAGE



SURESH PRABHU | SHOBHIT MATHUR

A child can learn what a chair is from a handful of examples. Give a child a few chairs of different shapes, sizes and colours, and soon the child can recognise a chair they have never seen before. They can distinguish a chair from a table, infer that a stool belongs to the same conceptual family, and apply the idea to objects in unfamiliar settings. Human intelligence generalises from remarkably little data.

Now consider what it takes to reproduce even a fraction of this general-purpose intelligence artificially. OpenAI's latest frontier model, GPT-6 Astra, was developed through the company's largest training run, involving more than 100,000 GPUs at its Stargate facility, according to reporting on its launch. OpenAI describes Astra as its most capable model yet, with state-of-the-art performance across reasoning, computer use, coding, science and professional work.

The contrast is extraordinary. A human brain, weighing roughly 1.3 kilograms, operates on approximately 20 watts of metabolic power. It learns continuously, generalises from sparse experience and adapts to situations it has never encountered. We can now build artificial systems of extraordinary capability, but achieving that capability requires industrial-scale computing infrastructure.

This is not merely a technological curiosity. It may be one of India's most important strategic opportunities. The global AI race is increasingly becoming a race of scale. The largest companies are accumulating GPUs, data, capital and engineering talent at a rate that few countries or institutions can match. India should absolutely participate in this race. We need computing infrastructure, foundational models, chips, data centres and world-class AI researchers. But there is little strategic value in deciding that our ambition is to become the second-best version of something that someone else has already built. There is no enduring national advantage in being second at the same game.

India needs to investigate a different question: why does biological intelligence achieve so much generalisation, abstraction and adaptability with so little energy and so little experience?

We still do not have a satisfactory scientific answer. We understand many components of the brain and have made enormous advances in neuroscience, but we do not possess a comprehensive theory of how intelligence emerges from them. We do not fully understand how the brain forms abstractions, transfers knowledge across domains, learns continuously without catastrophic loss of previous knowledge, or constructs useful models of the world from relatively sparse experience.

These are precisely the questions that could produce disproportionate advances in AI. A better understanding of biological intelligence could lead to fundamentally different approaches to learning and computation. A new principle for generalisation could matter more than another generation of larger models. A radically more efficient architecture could matter more than another expansion of computing infrastructure. The largest opportunity may therefore lie not in scaling today's paradigm, but in discovering what today's paradigm is missing.

This is a difficult research programme, and that is precisely why universities should pursue it. Markets and companies naturally favour research with identifiable commercial returns. Fundamental questions about cognition, abstraction and consciousness may take decades to resolve and may produce no immediate product. Yet some of the most consequential technologies in modern history emerged from research whose eventual applications were impossible to predict at the time.

Modern neuroscience has developed increasingly powerful instruments for observing the brain from the outside. Perhaps the next advances will require us to combine these measurements with much more systematic investigation of subjective experience from within. It requires recognising that a complete science of cognition may need methods capable of connecting first-person experience with third-person measurement. This could become a distinctive Indian research programme: neuroscience, cognitive science, AI, mathematics, philosophy and contemplative practice brought together around one fundamental question: what are the computational principles of intelligence?

The objective should not be to build an Indian copy of GPT-6 Astra. By the time we reproduce today's frontier, the frontier will have moved again. The objective should be to understand something that the frontier itself does not yet understand.

India should therefore make two bets. We should invest aggressively in the infrastructure required to compete in today's AI economy. Alongside it, we should create long-horizon research programmes willing to pursue questions where the probability, timing and form of the payoff are unknown.

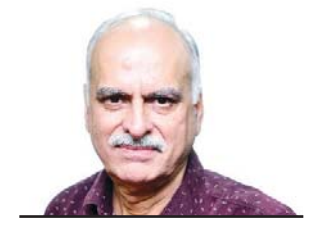
The second bet may turn out to be far more important. The 20-watt brain is telling us something profound. Intelligence does not necessarily require enormous amounts of computation. We simply do not yet understand how nature achieves it.

India's opportunity is to study that gap. If we spend the next decade trying to catch the leaders, we may become very good at following them. If we spend part of that decade discovering a fundamentally different theory of intelligence, we may have a chance to lead.

MODERN NEUROSCIENCE HAS DEVELOPED INCREASINGLY POWERFUL INSTRUMENTS FOR OBSERVING THE BRAIN FROM THE OUTSIDE. PERHAPS THE NEXT ADVANCES WILL REQUIRE US TO COMBINE THESE MEASUREMENTS WITH MUCH MORE SYSTEMATIC INVESTIGATION OF SUBJECTIVE EXPERIENCE FROM WITHIN. IT REQUIRES RECOGNISING THAT A COMPLETE SCIENCE OF COGNITION MAY NEED METHODS CAPABLE OF CONNECTING FIRST-PERSON EXPERIENCE WITH THIRD-PERSON MEASUREMENT

Suresh Prabhu is a former Union Minister and parliamentarian. Shobhit Mathur is the co-founder and Vice-Chancellor of Rishihood University

EC divide raises questions over autonomy



ANIL ANAND

These are troubled times for the Election Commission of India (ECI). For decades, the body has been the standard-bearer of impartial polling, embracing new technology and earning international acclaim as a guide to other democracies on free and fair elections. That reputation now faces its sternest test.

According to an investigative report in *The Indian Express* on September 23, 2026, two of the three members of the Commission, Election Commissioners Sukhbir Singh Sandhu and Vivek Joshi, came close to open revolt against Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar, only to return to the same table and project normalcy. Their grievance was procedural. They recorded objections 14 times in 10 months to decisions and orders taken without their knowledge. The charge against the CEC is that he has sought to centralise the Commission's functioning, a direct affront to the democratic spirit of a collegiate body.

Controversy is not new to Nirvachan Sadan. The biggest turmoil before this came under T N Seshan, when the poll panel was converted from a solo-driven vehicle into a three-member body. Seshan went to court against the government's decision and made his fellow Election Commissioners, G V G Krishnamurthy and Manohar Singh Gill, parties to the case. Later, CEC N Gopalaswami wrote to the government seeking the removal of Election Commissioner Navin Chawla. The government of the day rejected the plea, and Chawla, who had close links with the Gandhi family, ultimately retired as CEC himself.

In nearly two decades of covering the ECI, I have watched professional and personal rivalries between commissioners play out, sometimes in the open. This is different. An Election Commissioner dissenting from the other two, or the reverse, is one thing. Here, the majority of the Commission says it was bypassed by a minority.

The law is clear. Section 18(2) of the Chief Election Commissioner and other Election Commissioners (Appointment, Conditions of Service and Term of Office) Act, 2023, says all business of the Commission shall, as far as possible, be transacted unanimously. Where the CEC and the Election Commissioners differ, the matter "shall be decided according to the opinion of the majority". Even the procedure for transacting and allocating business can be regulated only by unanimous decision. The principle is older than the statute. In T N Seshan vs Union of India (1995), the Supreme Court stressed that Article 324 entrusts elections to the Commission, not to an individual.

The two Election Commissioners then wrote to the Cabinet Secretary about happenings in an autonomous constitutional body. The step is puzzling, though it conveys the gravity of the situation, since the proper authority was the President of India. The ECI has since said the letters concerned an officer on deputation and no policy matter.



At the heart of the row is the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of the electoral rolls. A storm was already brewing around it. Former CEC S Y Qureshi has described the SIR in its present form as "illegal and unconstitutional". Now it emerges that much of it was done without the knowledge of two of the three commissioners. As reported, Sandhu and Joshi objected repeatedly to procedural flaws and to being kept out of the loop on adding new voters and deleting names. They described the steps on new voters as "unauthorised, illegal", warned against access to the voter database being centralised in Delhi while bypassing state officials, and flagged concerns over the integrity of the voter software. They also objected to IT department heads becoming super-heads on changes to the rolls while senior ECI officials were kept out. The full Commission did not meet between May and August 2026, which points to a deeper malady in the poll panel.

Did Kumar act on his own? Or is he part of a wider net, controlled from above, as Leader of Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi alleges? Gandhi sees the report as vindication of his earlier charge that electoral manipulation helped the ruling dispensation win. At his press conference after the exposé, he tried to link the CEC to the top hierarchy of the Central government. Kumar can hardly feel comfortable after a former Kerala Chief Secretary claimed that Kumar, then a serving officer, had sounded him out about contesting the Lok Sabha election on a BJP ticket. Was he bidding on behalf of the saffron party bosses?

Surprisingly, the ruling BJP seems to have walked willingly into Gandhi's trap. The ECI's own rebuttal was guarded and deadpan, steering clear of the contentious issues. The BJP was more upfront, pressing its spokespersons into service "to defend the ECI". That drew a sharp remark from columnist Tavleen Singh, no one's idea of a critic of the right, in an X post: "Is the BJP not embarrassed that their party spokesmen are speaking on behalf of the Election Commission? Is that not in itself a giveaway?"

In an official statement, the Commission played down the leaks, saying "differing views and observations are a normal part of deliberation". It conceded that members held differing opinions but insisted these did not reflect its official position. On September 26, the three commissioners met together and promised that agendas would be circulated in advance and minutes recorded. That is an indirect admission of what was missing.

The government's role will come under scrutiny because Kumar is the first CEC appointed under the controversial 2023 Selection Act, which gave the executive a clear advantage on the selection panel by removing the Chief Justice of India. The exposé has revived the allegation that a centralised poll panel is being used to the government's advantage. Handled badly, it can have serious repercussions for the government, though it rises above party lines.

An institution whose only real currency is public trust cannot let that trust be settled through press notes and spokespersons. The way back lies in transparency: let the record of who decided what, and when, speak for itself.

The writer is a commentator on socio-political issues

A new generation takes aim



VIRENDRA SACHDEVA

As the curtain falls on the Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya, Indian archery returns home with nine medals: five gold, two silver and two bronze.

Behind every one of those medals lies a story of courage and sacrifice, and of a sporting ecosystem that has truly come of age.

For centuries, the image of Arjuna fixing his gaze on the eye of the bird has stood as India's timeless lesson in focus. In Aichi-Nagoya, that lesson came alive. Our archers saw nothing but the target: not the reputation of their opponents, not the weight of history, not the pressure of a watching nation. They saw only the ten, and they found it, time and again.

Our compound archers swept all three team titles, men's, women's and mixed, for the second consecutive Asian Games. The women's compound team equalled the world record in the final, and the mixed compound pair secured India's quota for the LA 2028 Olympics, where compound archery will make its Olympic debut.

Yet the defining story of these Games was written in recurve, a discipline long dominated by Korea. Our women's recurve team ended Korea's run of seven successive Asian Games titles to claim India's first-ever gold in the event. Our mixed recurve pair won India's first medal in that event, and our men's recurve team earned a second consecutive silver. Then, on the final day, a 17-year-old held her nerve in the individual recurve final to win a historic gold and secure an Olympic berth for India. Her composure under pressure is a lesson in how fearless India's young athletes have become.

It is equally heartening that our women led from the front. From recurve to compound, they delivered whenever it mattered most, and they will inspire countless young girls across India to pick up a bow.

These results weren't a day's success, but are the fruit of nearly fifteen years of sustained, collective effort: world-class infrastructure, quality equipment, international coaching expertise, sports science and regular global exposure. There were times when the podium felt within reach yet just beyond our grasp, but the faith of our coaches, support staff and families never wavered. In Nagoya, our athletes also contended with demanding conditions, long commutes, testing winds and heavy rains, yet their poise through it all speaks volumes about their character.



This transformation would be incomplete without acknowledging the visionary leadership of our Prime Minister, Narendra Modi. Under his stewardship, sport has moved from the periphery of national priorities to its very centre. Khelo India has unearthed talent from the farthest corners of our nation, while the Target Olympic Podium Scheme has given our elite athletes the support and dignity they deserve. Above all, the Prime Minister has changed how India regards its sportspersons. He stands beside them in triumph and in disappointment, assuring every young athlete from the smallest town that a billion hopes stand behind them.

Having been with the sports administration for a while now, I have witnessed many campaigns, but Nagoya was a first even for me. While I was with the team, the Hon'ble Union Sports Minister personally called not once but twice to ask after our athletes, their preparation and their well-being. That is the culture the Government under Prime Minister Narendra Modi has built, one where the highest offices of the nation stand shoulder to shoulder with our athletes, not only on the podium but at every step of the journey.

When a nation honours its athletes, it begins to believe in them. Where there is belief, champions follow. The medals of Aichi-Nagoya, won by young Indians who refused to be intimidated, are the clearest testament to this new sporting India.

To our archers: you have filled 1.4 billion hearts with pride. To the coaches, support staff and families whose sacrifices so often go unseen: these medals belong equally to you.

I am confident that under the exemplary leadership of our Prime Minister, Narendra Modi ji, India will flourish in every sporting discipline and take its rightful place among the world's great sporting nations. As for our archers, they have shown Asia what they are capable of. They are ready for the Olympics, and the world will soon take note.

Jai Hind!

The writer is the Secretary General, Archery Association of India

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NEW DELHI | FRIDAY | OCTOBER 9, 2026

Security heightened outside CEC house

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi


CEC Gyanesh Kumar's residence in Delhi

Security outside Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar's residence in New Moti Bagh has been stepped up after fresh threat inputs and a sharp escalation in protests by the INDIA bloc over the Election Commission's Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls.

The CEC already enjoys Z-plus cover, the second-highest civilian security category in the country after the Special Protection Group protection extended to the Prime Minister and his immediate family. Officials said the category already involves roughly fifty personnel working in shifts, with layered arrangements for the protectee's residence, movement and cavalcade.

In the latest review, additional police and Central Industrial Security Force personnel have been placed outside the house, at Nirvachan Sadan on Ashoka Road, and with his personal security detail. The CISF reinforcement of "additional reserve" strength was ordered on October 7.

Local district police have also been told to increase deployment and coordinate with other agencies to prevent any untoward incident as protests continue in the New Delhi district. A senior police officer said the decision followed a new threat assessment. Protesters found Kumar's home in New Moti Bagh colony, and some tried to enter the area and approach the house.

Security pickets were set up nearby. In a separate incident, protesters demonstrated outside his family's home in Agra. Security staff in the colony confirmed that more paramilitary personnel were stationed inside the complex because of the protests.

Delhi Police officials said CEC has had Z-plus security for some time, and the latest move only strengthens this arrangement instead of changing his security category. With this cover, over fifty officers from central armed police forces and Delhi Police are on duty.

He also has personal security officers, watchers, and close-protection teams working around the clock. The extra security comes as Opposition parties step up their campaign for the CEC's resignation. INDIA bloc leaders, led by Lok Sabha Opposition Leader Rahul Gandhi, have accused the Commission of irregularities in the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls and of favouring the Government.

Senior Congress leaders Mallikarjun Kharge and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra, along with leaders from the Samajwadi Party and Trinamool Congress, have also called for the CEC's removal. On October 6, Opposition leaders marched to the Election Commission headquarters, but police stopped them and detained several people.

Later, more attempts to reach protest sites, including Jantar Mantar, led to more detentions before the leaders were released. On October 5, authorities deployed about 5,000 security personnel for separate protests in the capital, and over 120 protesters were briefly detained.

The protests have spread beyond Delhi. Earlier, Youth Congress workers spray-painted slogans on the gate and walls of the family's Agra home, calling the Chief Election Commissioner a "traitor" and a "vote thief."

Student and youth groups have held sit-ins and torch-light marches in several cities, and a larger Opposition protest is planned for October 10. Police and intelligence agencies have been told to monitor the situation closely.

The political dispute over the revision process has continued for weeks. Opposition parties claim there have been large-scale deletions and a lack of transparency.

The Commission says that any differences among Election Commissioners during internal talks do not change the fact that final decisions, including those on the revision, were unanimous. The Supreme Court has sent a notice to the Commission and the Centre about a plea questioning some decisions linked to the CEC.

Kerala BJP chief slams Satheesan over detention

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Thiruvananthapuram


Keralam BJP president Rajeev Chandrasekhar

Keralam BJP president Rajeev Chandrasekhar on Thursday accused Chief Minister VD Satheesan of trying to distract Keralam people with "fake protests about democracy" while his administration was allegedly violating law and fundamental rights through its actions against Thiruvananthapuram Corporation councillor R Sugathan.

Congress leader Rahul Gandhi's protests against CEC Gyanesh Kumar as a "fraud drama," the BJP leader alleged.

Chandrasekhar's 'X' post came in the wake of Satheesan's participation in the agitation in Delhi against the CEC and his social media posts criticising the detention of Rahul Gandhi during the protest.

The CM on Wednesday said that the FIR against Gandhi for questioning electoral integrity is an "attack" on democratic dissent. He also said, "the fight against irregularities in the electoral rolls and for free and fair elections continues. Democracy will not be silenced."

Replying to the CM, Chandrasekhar said, "To CM @vdsatheesan, don't waste your time and try to distract malayalees with your fake protestations about democracy, secularism and the constitution when your administration is covering itself with violations of law, justice and fundamental rights."

New CAPF administration law comes into force amid SC challenge

PRAMOD KUMAR SINGH
New Delhi



The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) on Wednesday brought the Central Armed Police Forces (General Administration) Act, 2026 into force, converting a fiercely contested statute into the working law for the leadership of India's largest internal-security formations even as the Supreme Court continues to hear challenges to its validity.

Parliament passed the Act in early April, and the President approved it on April 9, 2026. The law covers Group A general-duty officers in the CRPF, BSF, CISF, ITBP, and SSB. The Government set the enforcement date for October 8. Now, the Centre-drafted rules on recruitment, promotion, deputation, and service conditions are in effect. The law sets aside half of Inspector General posts for Indian Police Service (IPS) officers on deputation, at least 67 per cent of Additional Director General posts for the same group, and all Special Director General and Director General posts for deputation. The Centre also gets rule-making powers that apply even if previous judgments or orders say otherwise, and the Act takes priority over other laws in case of a conflict. The Government says this system aims to bring consistency and clear roles across the five forces that handle border security, protect key sites, and manage counter-insurgency.

Cadre officers see the law differently. Over 3,000 serving Group A officers, including gallantry award winners and women officers, have petitioned the Supreme Court to strike down important parts of the law as unconstitutional. They say Sections 3 and 4 block their path to top positions, which the court had opened for them last year. They believe Parliament has undone a court judgment instead of following it.

One of the main petitioners is a CRPF officer who has received the Shaurya Chakra. The petitioners want the court to declare the disputed sections unconstitutional and to order that higher administrative posts should go to qualified executive cadre officers from within the forces.

The officers want to restore the Supreme Court's May 23, 2025, decision in Sanjay Prakash versus Union of India. In that ruling, the court said the CAPFs are organised Group A services, ordered a review of the cadre within six months, and told the Centre to reduce IPS deputation up to the Senior Administrative Grade gradually. The Government's review petition was dismissed in October 2025. Contempt proceedings began after the MHA reported that 46 IPS officers were still deputed to the five forces after the judgment. A special bench was constituted after a contempt petition disappeared from the cause list, prompting the court to seek an explanation from the Registry and note that too much heat can be generated from a listing dispute.

Further hearings have been fixed later this month and into November, with the Centre and the petitioners still exchanging pleadings. The bench will have to read three things together: the 2025 directions, the cadre-review exercise the Ministry says is under way, and a statute that now writes deputation quotas into law.

For officers who have spent their careers leading companies and battalions, this issue is very real. If a post is reserved for deputation, it cannot be earned through seniority or field service within the force.

The MHA sees these posts as a place where civil-police experience should combine with paramilitary leadership. The notification issued on Wednesday does not resolve this debate. It simply means the debate is now about a law already in effect, awaiting a court decision on whether it will stand.

BJP hits out at Rahul, Priyanka over alleged conduct with cops

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



As the Congress intensified its protest, the BJP on Thursday accused Rahul Gandhi of "inappropriately touching" a female constable and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra of "punching" a cop during their street protest, and claimed that the Congress leaders' actions were not consistent with their slogan of "smash the patriarchy".

The Congress was also trying to create "Nepal-and Bangladesh-like anarchy" in the country through its protests, as Rahul Gandhi is "desperate" to come to power, BJP spokesperson Pradeep Bhandari alleged.

Addressing a press conference at the BJP headquarters here, party spokesperson Sidharth Yadav accused Rahul and Priyanka of attacking police personnel during the protests. Yadav said the visuals being circulated were not of a protest but showed "the anarchy being spread in the national capital" under the leadership of Rahul Gandhi and the Congress.

He alleged that Rahul "inappropriately touched" a woman police constable and claimed that Priyanka "punched a female police officer in the stomach".

"The conduct of Rahul Gandhi in inappropriately touching a female constable is totally unacceptable," he said. "Priyanka punched a female police officer in the stomach even though she was simply standing there and had not provoked anyone. This is beyond tolerance," he said. The BJP spokesperson also alleged that Congress workers kicked policemen after bringing them to the ground.

Referring to Rahul Gandhi's slogan "smash the patriarchy" and Priyanka Gandhi Vadra's "Ladki Hoon, Lad Sakti Hoon" slogans, Yadav questioned whether the alleged conduct of the Congress leaders was consistent with their stated positions.

"When she was hitting that female police officer, was this the slogan that was going through her mind?" he asked, referring to Priyanka. If that's not the case, "then the truth behind their slogans is now before the country", Yadav said. "Rahul Gandhi has said that there are 47 FIRs against him. But wearing an FIR relating to an alleged crime against a woman as a medal – only Rahul Gandhi can do this in the country," he said.

Will not allow religious conversion, love jihad or land jihad: Suvendu

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Malda (WB)


CM Suvendu Adhikari

West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari on Thursday said religious conversion, "love jihad" and "land jihad" will not be allowed during his tenure.

Addressing a relief distribution programme in Muslim-majority Malda, Adhikari said religious conversion had occurred in the district's Kaliachak area in the past, but that should not be repeated.

"If it happens in my tenure, no one will be worse than me. I am telling you that there should not be any more religious conversion anywhere. As long as I am alive, I will not allow Mothabari and Kaliachak (incidents to happen again)," Adhikari added. A case had been filed in 2023 alleging forced conversion of two brothers in Mothabari in the district bordering Bangladesh.

There had been communal riots where Hindus suffered the most, the chief minister said. "Love jihad and land jihad will be stopped. We have given land to BSF. Not even a fly will be allowed to enter," Adhikari said.

The West Bengal Government has transferred 142.79 acres of land to the BSF in May for barbed-wire fencing and border outposts in several districts including Malda.

On the Citizenship (Amendment) Act, Adhikari said applicants would no longer have to approach others for certificates, as the Centre had given the state the power to issue them.

Varanasi set to witness spectacular IAF aerial display on October 25

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Varanasi is all set to witness a spectacular ceremonial aerial display on October 25, marking the IAF's 94th anniversary. The flying display will encapsulate the theme for the celebrations: 'Infallible Impervious and Precise,' it was learnt. Frontline fighter jets, including Rafales, Su-30MKI and Apache helicopters, are likely to enthral the audience.

Ceremonial fly-pasts showcase the IAF's air assets and also provide a platform to bolster its connect with the masses. The IAF on Thursday held a vibrant parade at the Hindan air base, Ghaziabad to celebrate over nine decades of the force since its inception on October 8, 1932.

The upcoming flying display will encapsulate the theme for the celebrations: 'Infallible Impervious and Precise'. The IAF had put up a spectacular flying display over the majestic Brahmaputra river in Guwahati besides the traditional parade at the Hindan air base as part of the force's 93rd anniversary celebrations in November 2025.

An array of fighter, transport and helicopter aircraft had flown past the Lachit Ghat, adding to the vibrant hues of Guwahati. The line-up reflected the wide array of aircraft the IAF has in its fleet.

ighlights in last year's fly past included jets such as Tejas, Apache, C-295 and Hawks, symbolising the pathway to national resilience.

Besides, Su-30 MKI and Rafale had enthralled the audience in Assam with breathtaking low-level aerobatics. The performance had concluded with synchronised manoeuvring by the Suryakiran Aerobatics Team (SKAT) and Sarang helicopter display team, leaving the audience spellbound.

In his address at the Air Force Day celebrations at the Hindan air base, Air Chief Marshal A P Singh said that since its inception in 1932, the IAF has evolved into an exceptional, network-centric and multi-domain force that is alert and ready to meet any challenges.

Besides the ceremonial parade, a static display of some of its prized combat assets such as Rafale and Tejas and a fly past by three Mi-17 helicopters was also hosted.

Nana Patekar leaves behind an unfulfilled dream of settling in Uttarakhand's mountains

ANJALI YADAV ■ Dehradun



Nana Patekar's connection with Uttarakhand's mountains lives on in the memories of people he met during a film shoot in Chamoli, where the said he wanted to build a house and spend his holidays in the mountains. Patekar, one of Indian cinema's acclaimed actors, died aged 75 on Thursday after reportedly suffering a cardiac arrest in Goa.

His Uttarakhand connection dates back to September 2022, when he visited Chamoli the shoot a Marathi film. The unit shot in Lata, Malari and areas around the Niti Valley. During his stay in the areas of the district bordering Nepal and China, Patekar interacted with residents and experienced their food, traditional lifestyle, weather, and peaceful surroundings. According to locals, He was deeply impressed by the simplicity and beauty of the region and spoke about building a house there.

Patekar stayed with his crew at a homestay in Lata. Homestay owner Narendra Singh Rana recalled that the actor stayed there for seven days and had a separate kitchen where he cooked dishes including chicken and mutton. "He would call everyone together, sometimes scold them jokingly, and then serve them food," Rana recalled. Rana said Patekar told him he would return and book the homestay for eight days with his friends.

He also said he wanted to buy a small piece of land in Lata and build a small house where he could spend his holidays every year. Rana also remembered Patekar as being warm towards visitors and guests at the homestay, talking to them and posing for photographs. During the shoot, Patekar also visited Narayan Koti and Devar areas in Rudraprayag, where he enjoyed local food, including mandua roti and rai-palak.

He also visited Dehradun and praised Uttarakhand's natural beauty and the hospitality of its people. During the visit, he met the chief minister Pushkar Singh Dhami and described the State as an ideal location for film shoots.

Nearly four years later, Patekar's wish to make the mountains his home remained unfulfilled. For the people who met him, however, his brief stay in Uttarakhand remains a cherished memory of an actor who came to the mountains for work but left with a personal dream of returning.

Government plans AI rules on safety, deepfakes within a month: Vaishnaw

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi


IT minister Ashwini Vaishnaw

Union IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw on Thursday said the Centre will bring out a consultation paper on AI regulations in a month, dealing with aspects like AI safety, a human-first approach, and deepfakes. He added that the time for such a framework has come, and that industry must shoulder the bulk of the responsibility.

The move assumes significance as concerns over deepfakes, cyber threats and the psychological effects of AI chatbots are growing, and leading researchers have repeatedly called for stronger safeguards. Across the world, governments and regulators are racing to keep pace with fast-moving AI, with the European Union already enacting a comprehensive Artificial Intelligence (AI) Act.

While speaking at an event on the release of the World Development Report, Vaishnaw noted that deepfakes are a "nuisance which can cause huge problems in society", and added that their quality is improving every day. The India Launch of the World Development Report 2026: The Promise of Artificial Intelligence was organised by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY), through the IndiaAI Mission, in collaboration with the World Bank Group.

"People believe them, and it sets a totally wrong precedent. It sets a totally wrong narrative, and people get lured into doing wrong things and believing wrong things," he said, adding the upcoming consultation paper would deal with AI harms and deepfakes as a big area of focus.

"I'll request the department to come out with a regulation-focused consultation paper, which focuses on safety. That's the most important point...safety-related to AI use," Vaishnaw said.

Vaishnaw further said that the upcoming consultation paper will form the basis for AI regulations, and added that the time has come for India to have such a framework. Other issues that the consultation paper would prioritise are AI harms, including deepfakes, a human-first approach, skilling, as well as a commitment to leave no person behind, the Minister elaborated. "Humanity has to be the most important part of change that has happened," Vaishnaw said.

Vaishnaw made it clear that the industry must shoulder the bulk of the responsibility. "The industry has to take the primary responsibility," he said, listing out issues such as cybersecurity, safety, user harm, psychological disorders and deepfakes. "So we'll come out with that paper in a month's time from now, and based on that we'll go forward with the regulation," Vaishnaw said.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | FRIDAY | OCTOBER 9, 2026

COMFED expands SUDHA's presence in Assam, North-East

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Guwahati



Bihar State Milk Co-operative Federation Ltd (COMFED), which markets dairy products under the SUDHA brand, is strengthening its presence in Assam and the adjoining North-Eastern States through expanded processing capacity and a growing retail network.

As part of the expansion, Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma inaugurated a 20,000 litres per day (LPD) milk processing plant at Kanyaka Dairy, Shantipur, Jamugurihat, Tezpur, Sonitpur, on Thursday. Shirsat Kapil Ashok, IAS, Chairman-cum-Managing Director, COMFED, attended the inauguration.

The new plant is expected to strengthen supplies to Tezpur and adjoining areas and support further expansion of SUDHA's regional distribution network.

SUDHA expands retail network in Assam, North-East

COMFED began marketing SUDHA pouch milk and milk products in Guwahati in November 2018 through a third-party dairy facility at Amingaon. Since then, it has expanded operations to other parts of Assam and neighbouring states, Meghalaya and Arunachal Pradesh.

At present, COMFED's Guwahati unit markets a range of SUDHA products, including pouch milk, curd, paneer, lassi, peda and milk cake, through approximately 2,200 retail outlets.

Average milk sales from the unit stand at around 50,500 litres per day. During the financial year 2025-26, the unit recorded a turnover of ₹121.17 crore and a profit of ₹8.06 crore, reflecting the growing acceptance of the SUDHA brand in the region.

Assam offers significant potential for dairy sector

The North-East, particularly Assam, offers considerable potential for the organised dairy sector.

According to the National Dairy Development Board (NDDB), Assam's household demand for milk and milk products is projected to increase to 89.87 lakh litres per day by 2030.

The projected increase indicates substantial scope to expand dairy supplies, processing infrastructure, and retail distribution in the State.

Expansion in the North-East requires reliable processing and distribution arrangements to serve markets spread across different locations and terrain. COMFED's approach seeks to bring processing closer to these markets, improve supply reliability and make SUDHA products more widely accessible to consumers.

COMFED plans one lakh LPD dairy facility

COMFED has also begun steps to set up its own dairy processing facility in Assam, with a proposed capacity of one lakh litres per day.

For the proposed project, COMFED has requested the Government of Assam to allot suitable land. The Assam Industrial Development Corporation (AIDC) has identified potential locations and shown them to COMFED for consideration.

Focus on 'cooperation among cooperatives'

As a dairy cooperative federation, COMFED's expansion also offers scope to advance the principle of "cooperation among cooperatives."

Collaboration in milk sourcing, processing, distribution, and technical support can help cooperative institutions share resources and expertise, strengthen market access, and improve services for producers and consumers.

Such partnerships can connect Bihar's established dairy cooperative network with opportunities in the North-East and support the wider development of cooperative dairying.

COMFED contributes to Assam flood relief

Alongside its business operations, COMFED has also contributed to relief efforts in Assam. During the recent floods, its Guwahati unit donated ₹4 lakh to the Chief Minister's Relief Fund.

Assam Chief Minister Himanta Biswa Sarma appreciated the contribution.

UP to become logistics hub as UPSIDA approves 4 new projects

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Lucknow



Uttar Pradesh is moving towards strengthening its position as one of the country's leading industrial and logistics hubs, with the Uttar Pradesh State Industrial Development Authority (UPSIDA) approving four new warehousing and logistics projects across the state.

The projects include one silo project, two warehousing projects and one logistics park. These projects will be established in Pilibhit, Unnao, Gautam Buddha Nagar and Ayodhya districts.

The initiatives are being undertaken under the leadership and guidance of Uttar Pradesh Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath to accelerate industrial development in the state and contribute to the vision of making Uttar Pradesh a $1 trillion economy.

₹14,600 crore Investment Proposed Across 75 Projects

With approval for four new projects, UPSIDA has so far approved 75 projects under the Uttar Pradesh Warehousing & Logistics Policy-2022 and the PIP Policy.

These projects are proposed to be developed over approximately 960 acres of land, with a total proposed investment of around ₹14,600 crore.

Implementing these projects is expected to expand the state's modern warehousing and logistics infrastructure significantly. In particular, the projects will increase capacity for safe, scientific storage of food grains and provide farmers with better warehousing and logistics facilities.

The projects will also accelerate the development of warehousing clusters, modern distribution centres, silos and cold-chain facilities across the state. This is expected to make the agricultural supply chain more efficient and seamless while facilitating faster movement of agricultural produce to markets.

New employment opportunities alongside investment

Growing investment in the warehousing and logistics sector is expected to strengthen the state's infrastructure and generate significant direct and indirect employment opportunities.

These projects will stimulate local economic activity in areas such as transportation, warehousing, packaging, distribution, and allied services, contributing to inclusive economic growth.

Policy incentives strengthening investor confidence

The Uttar Pradesh Warehousing & Logistics Policy-2022, introduced by the state Government , aims to establish Uttar Pradesh as a modern, competitive and globally competitive logistics hub.

Under the policy, the state provides investors with various incentives, financial assistance, tax-related benefits, and other facilitation measures to establish warehousing and logistics units in the State.

The rapidly expanding expressway network, industrial corridors, and rail and air connectivity further enhance Uttar Pradesh's attractiveness as a preferred destination for investment in the logistics and warehousing sector.

UPSIDA is also placing particular emphasis on providing investors with a simple, transparent, and time-bound approval process, ensuring that investment proposals translate into ground-level projects at the earliest and contribute to investment, employment generation, and economic activity across the State.

Ghaziabad Municipal Commissioner hears public grievances

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Ghaziabad



Ghaziabad Municipal Commissioner Vikramaditya Singh Malik heard public grievances under the 'Sambhav' programme and directed concerned officials to take prompt action on all 19 references received during the public hearing.

Of the 19 grievances, eight pertained to the Construction Department, one to the Health Department, one to the Horticulture Department, three to the Street Lighting Department, three to the Property Department, one to the Tax Department, and two to the Jal Kal (Water Works) Department.

The concerned departments of the Ghaziabad Municipal Corporation immediately took action on the complaints.

The Municipal Commissioner said that under the Sambhav programme, the department aims to address grievances received during the public hearing on the same day.

Several elected councillors also raised issues in their respective wards and put forward suggestions in residents' interest. Councillors from Ward No. 24 (Maharoli), Ward No. 74 (Vasundhara), Ward No. 89 (Vaishali), Ward No. 18 (Rajapur) and Ward No. 88 (Gandhi Nagar) discussed various civic issues. They offered suggestions for improving facilities in their areas.

Mega drive to remove illegal encroachments in Vijay Nagar

The hearing also received a specific complaint about illegal encroachment in Vijay Nagar.

Taking the issue seriously, Municipal Commissioner Vikramaditya Singh Malik directed the concerned departments to conduct a joint mega enforcement drive in Vijay Nagar and take strict action against illegal encroachments.

During the public hearing, the Ghaziabad Municipal Corporation also initiated action on various complaints received.

Additional Municipal Commissioner Renu Singh, General Manager (Jal Kal) Kamakhya Prasad Anand, Incharge Horticulture Dr Anuj, Municipal Health Officer Dr Mithilesh, Chief Tax Assessment Officer Anirudh Kumar, along with officials of the Street Lighting Department, were present during the hearing.

Special Street Lighting Campaign Ahead of Festivals

In view of the upcoming festivals, the Municipal Commissioner also directed the Street Lighting Department to undertake a special campaign across all wards to ensure street lights function properly and are properly maintained.

The complainants appreciated the Ghaziabad Municipal Corporation's prompt response and action during the Sambhav public hearing and expressed gratitude for the timely resolution of their grievances.

Bastar Dussehra scripts a tale of tourism

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



Besieged by Naxal menace for the last three decades, Bastar has now changed tack after the elimination of ultra-Left terror as it pulls tourists who are venturing into the region's forests, waterfalls and tribal culture. Bastar's tourism numbers are now telling a story the region has not been able to witness for a long time.

Post monsoon, Bastar is at its most dramatic: the forests thicken, the waterfalls swell, and the usual trickle of visitors turns into something closer to a rush. Hotel and homestay operators near the region's main attractions say they have already started preparing for the crowds expected around Bastar Dussehra, Navratri and Diwali.

Dussehra itself runs for 75 days this year, and it is being treated as something more than a religious calendar event. There is no Ravana effigy burnt here, unlike most of the country's Dussehra celebrations. Instead, the festival builds around a massive chariot, local folk tradition and tribal belief systems that have nothing to do with the Ramayana. That difference is part of the draw. President Droupadi Murmu's slated attendance this year has only added to the attention the festival is getting, and officials expect it to anchor Chhattisgarh's tourism calendar going forward.

Managing Director of the Chhattisgarh Tourism Board, Saumil Ranjan Chaubey puts it simply: the state is not chasing visitor numbers for their own sake. "The bigger goal is to connect tourism to the local economy directly, through eco-tourism, homestays, adventure tourism and better infrastructure, while bringing in local youth, women, artisans and small entrepreneurs as the people running these businesses rather than watching from outside," he said, adding, the improved security and connectivity in the region has added to the uptick already visible on the ground.

Dussehra is only part of what is drawing people in. Chitrakote Falls, Tirathgarh and Kanger Valley have become regular stops on itineraries that once began and ended with the festival. Inside Kanger Valley, the Kutumsar and Kailash caves offer a different kind of visit altogether, closer to the region's biodiversity and tribal life than to any festival schedule, and they are increasingly pulling tourism out of the main towns and into villages that rarely saw outside visitors before.

Homestays, local Bastariya food, Mahua-based products and handicrafts are turning into source of livelihood and income for people who had little access earlier. Guides, drivers, small shopkeepers, artisans, and women's self-help groups are among the beneficiaries.

Alok Tiwari entrusted with additional charge of managing director of DFCCIL



Alok Tiwari

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi

Alok Tiwari, IRSE, Additional Member (Bridge), Railway Board, has been entrusted with the additional charge of Managing Director of Dedicated Freight Corridor Corporation of India Limited (DFCCIL), in addition to his existing responsibilities.

Tiwari assumed charge of the post on October 5, 2026. He was welcomed at the DFCCIL Corporate Office by Shobhit Bhatnagar, Director/OP&BD; Anurag Sharma, Director/Infrastructure; Pawan K Rai, Director/Project Planning; and B Mugunthan, Director/Finance, along with other senior officials of DFCCIL.

A 1988-batch IRSE officer, Tiwari has over 36 years of experience in Indian Railways, with extensive exposure to railway infrastructure planning, project execution, construction, safety, freight operations and administration.

Throughout his career, he has worked across the full project life cycle and has directly constructed and commissioned more than 1,000 km of railway infrastructure.

Extensive experience in railway infrastructure

Tiwari has held several key positions during his career, including Chief Administrative Officer, South East Central Railway; Principal Chief Safety Officer, South Western Railway; Divisional Railway Manager, Guntakal; and Chief Project Manager-cum-Group General Manager, RVNL.

His experience covers technical planning, major infrastructure projects, safety management, freight operations and organisational administration.

After assuming charge as Managing Director, Tiwari chaired a review meeting at the DFCCIL Corporate Office to take stock of key activities, ongoing works and operational priorities.

The meeting covered critical aspects of Dedicated Freight Corridor operations, construction, maintenance, asset reliability, safety, project progress and overall organisational performance.

Focus on Technology, Automation and Efficiency

During the review meeting, Tiwari emphasised the need for a coordinated, outcome-oriented, technology-driven approach across all functions, with a clear focus on improving efficiency, reliability, and productivity.

The meeting also discussed aligning the proposed East-West Dedicated Freight Corridor (EWDFC) and the way forward for its planning and development.

The meeting placed particular emphasis on greater mechanisation and automation in maintenance, adopting modern construction methodologies, wider use of precast solutions, and deploying Artificial Intelligence and digital technologies to enhance asset performance and enable data-driven decision-making.

Emphasis on knowledge management

The new Managing Director also stressed the importance of strengthening knowledge management and institutional memory within DFCCIL.

He called for creating a comprehensive digital repository of drawings and critical project data at the Corporate Office, supported by robust backup and archival arrangements. The initiative aims to ensure systematic preservation and effective utilisation of institutional knowledge.

Tiwari also called on officers to maintain a strong focus on quality, cost-effectiveness, timely execution, and operational excellence while leveraging technology and innovation to enhance DFCCIL's capabilities further.

With extensive experience in railway infrastructure, freight operations, safety, and project management, Tiwari takes charge at a key stage in the evolution of India's Dedicated Freight Corridor network.

His leadership is expected to strengthen further DFCCIL's focus on operational efficiency, asset reliability, technological innovation, and infrastructure excellence.

DFCCIL is entrusted with developing and operating the Dedicated Freight Corridors to enhance freight transportation capacity, improve logistics efficiency, and facilitate faster, safer, and more efficient movement of goods across the country.

NTPC concludes electron quiz 2026-27; IIT Madras teams take top honours

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
Noida



NTPC, India's largest integrated power utility, concluded its flagship Electron Quiz 2026-27 on October 8, an initiative aimed at encouraging curiosity, learning and fresh thinking among young minds. Organised from September 5, beginning with the regional round in Lucknow and culminating in the National Finale in Noida on October 8, the quiz was conducted across nine regional locations.

At the Grand Finale, Advik Kabra and Ashish Cherian Thannickal of IIT Madras emerged as the national champions. Sreeram Madhavan V and Ishaan Joshi of IIT Madras secured the second position, while Waqar Moid and Parth Arya Bhat of IIT Kanpur finished third.

Winners receive cash prizes

At the national level, the winning team was awarded ₹1,00,000, while the second- and third-placed teams received ₹60,000 and ₹40,000, respectively.

Teams securing the fourth, fifth, and sixth positions received ₹16,000 each, while the remaining 12 teams received ₹8,000 each.

Anil Kumar Jadli, Director (HR), NTPC, was present and congratulated the winners. He also complimented all participants for their enthusiasm and encouraged the students to carry forward the spirit of learning and curiosity in their future endeavours.

Speaking about NTPC's own journey of transformation, Jadli highlighted how the company is evolving beyond its traditional identity into an integrated energy major. He encouraged the youngsters to embrace the same spirit of transformation and adaptability in their own lives and careers.

Over 1,100 teams participate

The regional rounds were held across nine cities-Lucknow, Patna, Ranchi, Raipur, Mumbai, Chennai, Hyderabad, Kolkata and Noida.

More than 1,100 teams participated in the competition, making this year's edition one of the largest editions of the NTPC Electron Quiz.

At the regional level, the winning teams were awarded ₹60,000, while the second- and third-placed teams received ₹40,000 and ₹20,000, respectively. Teams that secured fourth, fifth, and sixth positions received ₹8,000 each.

Among others, SN Panigrahi, Executive Director (HR); Premlata, Executive Director (Strategic HRD & Talent Development); senior executives; employees; and students from various institutes were present to encourage the finalists.

Quiz Organised Since 2004

Since 2004, the NTPC Electron Quiz, themed 'The World of Business & Management', has been a flagship initiative that promotes learning and intellectual growth.

Over the years, the quiz has grown in scale and stature, giving students across the country a chance to learn and compete.

Meanwhile, NTPC Limited, a Maharatna company of the Government of India, is India's largest integrated power utility with an installed capacity of over 91 GW. As the company strengthens its position across the energy value chain, NTPC is expanding beyond conventional power generation into renewable energy and emerging areas, including battery energy storage, nuclear power, carbon capture, and green chemicals.

The company is targeting 60 GW of renewable energy capacity by 2032, as part of its broader commitment to India's evolving energy landscape.

PARADIP PORT AUTHORITY
e-TENDER CALL NOTICE
No.CE/PHD/ACCTS-07/26/328
Dtd.05.10.2026

Name of the Work: **"Operation and Maintenance (O&M) of 2.50 MLD STP-II at Brundaban Colony for two years (2027-29)".** Estimated cost: **Rs.1,58,00,972.10**. Last Date & time of submission : 26.10.2026 up to 18:00 Hrs. Refer our website for details: eprocure.gov.in/eprocure/app.

Sd/- Executive Engineer,
PHD, PPA
PPA/PR/30/2026-2027 dtd. 07.10.2026

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The Pioneer

NEW DELHI | FRIDAY | OCTOBER 9, 2026

SC directs steps to enhance women's safety

RAJESH KUMAR
New Delhi

Giving top priority to the safety of women, especially after recent incidents of crimes against them in Delhi-NCR, the Supreme Court on Thursday issued a series of directions to the police and state government to strengthen preventive measures, public transport security and surveillance.

Invoking the "Broken Windows" theory of policing while hearing the suo motu case it initiated over recent incidents of rape in Delhi NCR, a bench of Justice JB Pardiwala and Justice K Vinod Chandran observed that a broken streetlight, a non-functional CCTV camera or an unattended complaint, though minor in isolation, together convey that public spaces are not being watched. The bench similarly, noted that visible and unattended signs of civic neglect signal an absence of authority and create a safe haven for anti-social elements.

"A broken or inadequate streetlight, a non-functional CCTV camera, an unmonitored dark stretch, or an unaddressed public complaint may individually appear as minor administrative or infrastructural lapses. However, when such deficiencies remain visible and unattended over a period of time, they collectively convey a perception of neglect and diminished vigilance," the Court observed.

In a slew of sweeping measures the bench has ordered enhanced patrolling around



educational institutions, stringent verification of drivers and assistants operating public transport and app-based cabs, real time monitoring of police patrolling and CCTV infrastructure through dedicated control room command centres or "war rooms", removal of illegally parked heavy vehicles creating blind spots and action against unauthorised liquor outlets and eateries.

The court directed the Delhi government's chief secretary and the commissioner of police to submit periodic compliance reports. It said both officers would be "personally answerable" if the directions were not implemented seriously.

The bench directed that unauthorised liquor shops and establishments operating without requisite permissions be identified and dealt with in accordance with law. The top court issued notice to the Union Ministry of Home Affairs and the Delhi Transport Department and posted the matter for hearing on November 16. The bench asked authorities to ensure real-time monitoring of vehicle tracking and SOS systems to strengthen preventive policing and curb sexual offences in the national capital.

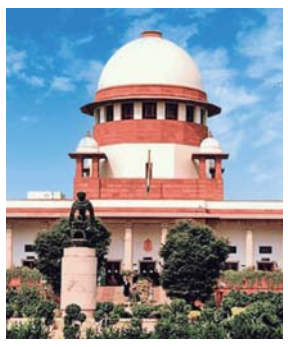
In its order, the bench said the manner in which public spaces are maintained, visible police patrolling and surveillance, and the promptness with which reported deficiencies are addressed are equally relevant to crime prevention. It also underscored the importance of effective real-time monitoring of police patrolling and CCTV infrastructure through dedicated control room command centres or "war rooms".

"Therefore, the Commissioner of Police, Delhi and the Chief Secretary, Government of NCT of Delhi, are hereby directed to furnish a joint report on (i) whether dedicated control room command centres of this nature currently exist within the NCT of Delhi and, if so, their exact number and the corresponding areas of coverage," the bench said.

"Hence, the police and the local administration shall consider instituting regular citizen-engagement meetings under the supervision of an officer to be designated for the purpose so that grievances may be received directly and their follow-up monitored efficiently," it said. The bench said training in preventive policing should form part of the induction of police personnel and be reinforced through periodic training at regular intervals thereafter.

Order Order

SC's forgiving nature led to rise in crime: Justice Datta



The Supreme Court on Thursday orally remarked that due to its forgiving nature in commutation of death sentences, the country is witnessing an increase in crime and this has to "come to an end somewhere".

A bench of justices Dipankar Datta and Sheel Nagu was hearing a plea seeking premature release of a life convict whose death sentence was commuted to life imprisonment in a murder case. Justice Datta orally remarked that earlier murder convictions were based on the 'rarest of rare' doctrine but times have changed.

"It is because of our forgiving nature, that India is facing these problems. Forgive, forgive, forgive, you have to draw a line somewhere," he said. Justice Datta recalled that the Supreme Court commuted death sentence in a case where a man raped and murdered his elder daughter.

"The father goes to jail on life imprisonment on the basis of the mother's testimony. After some years, the father comes out on parole and murders the mother in front of his younger daughter. "On the younger daughter's testimony, he is given death sentence. And then death sentence is commuted to life sentence by the Supreme Court on the ground that he did not murder the younger child. That is why we say, our forgiving nature has to come to an end somewhere," he said. (*PTI*)

Kerala HC asks TDB for Sabarimala works timeline



As the Sabarimala pilgrimage approaches, the Kerala High Court has asked the Travancore Devaswom Board to give the timeframe within which the preparations for it will be completed.

A bench of justices Raja Vijayaraghavan V and KV Jayakumar directed the Board to place on record a detailed statement regarding each of the works to be completed, the expected date of completion and measures to ensure the quality of the work.

"The statement shall also specify the time frame within which each work is expected to be completed and the mechanism put in place to ensure that the works are completed within the stipulated time and in accordance with the required standards," the court said.

It also asked the Board to state the manner in which the directions issued by Chief Minister VD Satheesan at the high-level meeting held on September 11 are proposed to be implemented and the steps taken to ensure compliance of the instructions.

The bench issued the directions while hearing a petition initiated by it regarding the various activities undertaken at the Lord Ayyappa temple during the monthly poojas there.

During the proceedings, the court was told by the state Government lawyer that several high-level meetings were convened by the State Devaswom Minister K Muraleedharan and the CM to review the preparatory activities undertaken by various Government departments and the Board for the Sabarimala pilgrimage 2026-2027 and to issue necessary directions. The lawyer also told the court that the CM had issued a firm direction that all pilgrimage-related preparatory works across all departments shall be completed on or before October 31. (*PTI*)

Set up panel to examine unethical pharma marketing practices: SC to Government

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Supreme Court on Thursday directed the Centre to constitute a committee within two weeks to undertake a holistic and comprehensive examination of issues relating to unethical pharmaceutical marketing practices.

The apex court directed that the committee would endeavour to complete the exercise in a time-bound manner and submit its recommendations to the Centre within two months from the date of its first meeting, after duly undertaking the consultative process and considering the material and suggestions placed before it.

A bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta passed the order on a plea concerning alleged prevalence of unethical marketing and promotional practices by pharmaceutical companies in their dealings with healthcare professionals.

The petitioners claimed that such practices include direct or indirect monetary benefits, gifts, hospitality, sponsored travel, entertainment and other inducements extended to medical practitioners with a view to influence their drug prescribing practices.

The bench noted that the Centre has proposed to constitute a three-member committee to examine the issue and make recommendations as to the appropriate statutory and regulatory framework for regulating the conduct of pharmaceutical companies.

"In view of the aforesaid discussion, and having regard to the constitutional obligation to protect the right to health as well as the continuing need for an effective and enforceable framework to regulate pharmaceutical marketing practices, we consider it appropriate to exercise our jurisdiction under Articles 32 and 142 of the Constitution," the bench said.

It said the directions issued by the court are intended to secure effective implementation of the existing framework and to facilitate the ongoing exercise of the Centre towards evolving an appropriate regulatory mechanism.

"The Union of India shall, if not already constituted, constitute the committee proposed by it within a period of two weeks from the date of this order," it said.

The bench said the committee would undertake a comprehensive examination of all issues relating to unethical pharmaceutical marketing practices, including the adequacy of existing statutory and regulatory framework, the efficacy of mechanisms presently in place for monitoring, oversight and enforcement, and the measures required to ensure greater transparency, accountability and effective compliance.

NHAI projects: SC seeks Punjab land proposal

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Supreme Court on Thursday directed the Punjab Government to submit a proposal for providing adequate land for compensatory afforestation in areas where land is required by the NHAI for construction of roads.

A bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana voiced its concern over reduction of forest cover in Punjab and lack of implementation of the afforestation plan.

"The State of Punjab is directed to submit a proposal re: provision of adequate land for compensatory afforestation wherever the same is required by the NHAI for construction of the subject-National Highways," it ordered.

The bench also issued notice on NHAI's plea challenging several orders of Punjab and Haryana High Court by which restrictions were placed on felling of trees by the authority during construction of roads. It sought the Punjab Government's response by November 27.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the National Highways Authority of India (NHAI), said the high court has issued continuing mandamus restraining felling of trees in Punjab, which is creating problem for construction of public roads.

"There cannot be a continuing mandamus. We are bound by a statutory requirement for compensatory afforestation. It is mandatory for felling of trees. Punjab is a border state and some roads are required to be constructed for strategic purposes," Mehta submitted. The bench asked whether land is allocated for compensatory afforestation within five km of the area where the trees are felled.

Mehta submitted that sometimes the land is allocated, sometimes it is not and sometimes it cannot be allocated within a five km radius but trees are being planted. He submitted that due to the high court's direction, public projects are being stalled.

The bench then directed the Punjab Government to submit a proposal for providing adequate land for compensatory afforestation, where land is required for construction of roads.

Group of ex-judges dub Opposition attack on EC campaign without evidence

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



A group of 42 retired judges have defended the Election Commission of India (ECI) against the Opposition onslaught and backed the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls, describing it as a lawful exercise.

In an open letter to the "people of India", the former judges of the Supreme Court and former chief justices and judges of various high courts said they hold no brief for any political party but felt compelled to speak as "silence is no longer a neutral choice".

The signatories include Former Chief Justice of Jammu and Kashmir and Delhi High Court BC Patel, Former Chief Justice of Karnataka High Court Subhro Kamal Mukherjee, former Supreme Court judges Hemant Gupta and Pankaj Mittal. The Opposition INDIA bloc leaders have accused Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) Gyanesh Kumar of revising electoral rolls to benefit the BJP and have sought his resignation. Both the BJP and the commission have rejected the allegation.

The former judges claimed that India's constitutional bodies are under "sustained attack", with the Election Commission of India at the centre of the assault.

"Even the higher judiciary, which we hold in high esteem, and statutory agencies have not been spared," the letter pointed out. They said the attacks were not reasoned criticism but appeared to be a "calculated campaign" driven by vested political interests, with little regard for the potentially devastating consequences of "destabilising the world's largest democracy".

The former judges described the attacks on the poll panel and other institutions as a "campaign without evidence". "Criticism of institutions is a democratic right. Denigration is not. Constitutional authorities are now branded 'thieves', 'puppets' and 'compromised' from public platforms," they lamented. On the SIR, the former judges noted that the electoral law empowers the EC to carry out revision of electoral rolls at any time.

They said SIRs had been carried out repeatedly since the first general elections, with the last such exercise completed about two decades ago. "No one called those revisions a conspiracy," they said. The former judges said the allegations of "vote theft" are made at press conferences, "not before courts".

"When the commission seeks a sworn declaration, none is filed. Electronic Voting Machines are blamed only after defeat. Victories won on the same machines go unquestioned," the letter said.

In an apparent reference to the Congress, they said a party that governed the nation for over five decades now claims that the very system which elected it is rigged. "It does not act alone. Activist outfits with a long record of selective litigation lend these claims a veneer of legality," it said. They file petition, "one after the other" but seldom give proof. The courtroom becomes a stage, and when the judgment is delivered, it is criticised whenever it does not serve their interests, the letter said.

"Vitriol is then amplified and disseminated on an industrial scale, with the deliberate aim of eroding public confidence in a well-established and widely trusted judicial system," they said.

On Tuesday, the INDIA bloc MPs marched from Parliament, and Rahul Gandhi observed an eight-hour sit-in at Akashvani Bhawan. On Wednesday, the scene shifted to nearby Jantar Mantar as Gandhi and other INDIA bloc leaders held a street protest against Kumar before being detained by the police later in the evening.

Thursday marked the third day of continuous protests in the national capital by top Opposition leaders.

Supreme Court sets aside elections in 50 wards in Punjab, orders fresh polls

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Supreme Court has ordered fresh elections in 50 municipal wards in Punjab after a fact-finding commission found "widespread obstruction during the nomination process" in the local body polls.

A bench comprising Chief Justice Surya Kant and Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana set aside elections in 50 wards — 28 in Patiala district and 22 in Moga. The top court passed the order after accepting the findings of a one-member commission headed by former high court judge Nirmaljit Kaur.

The local body elections took place on December 21, 2024. The commission was appointed on March 24, 2025, and it submitted its report on November 18, 2025.

"The principal finding of the Commission is of widespread obstruction during the nomination process, whereby nomination papers were snatched, torn or destroyed, and candidates were assaulted, detained or threatened. "We accept the recommendations and direct that fresh elections be conducted in the relevant 50 wards. The entire process of re-election shall be completed within six weeks," the bench said in the September 28 order which was uploaded last night.

The apex court noted the submission of senior advocate Kapil Sibal, appearing for the Punjab Government, that the state has no objection to the commission's recommendations. The top court asked the Chief Justice of the Punjab and Haryana High Court to nominate at least two or three senior members of the high court bar to act as 'Observers' in the re-election process.

"The filing, scrutiny/submission of nomination forms, allocation of symbols, polling, etc. shall be videographed in the presence of the said Observers. The recordings shall be duly preserved and handed over to the Monitoring Committee.

"The State of Punjab shall furnish to the Monitoring Committee, before the filing of nominations begins, a ward-wise list of the officers/officials deployed on election duty. Further, the list of police officers on duty in the rank of DSP and above shall also be furnished," the bench said.

The apex court said that any complaint concerning interference with, or obstruction of, the re-election process by any person, including any official, may be made to the Monitoring Committee.

"The honorarium payable to the Monitoring Committee as well as the Observers shall be fixed by the Chief Justice of the High Court.

"The honorarium as well as the incidental expenses of the Monitoring Committee and the Observers shall be borne by the Government of Punjab, which shall also provide them with the necessary secretarial, transportation, logistical, and security support," the bench said.

SC asks Centre to furnish details of rehab centres for disabled children across India

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
New Delhi



The Supreme Court on Thursday sought State-wise details on the regulation, standards and monitoring mechanisms governing rehabilitation centres for children with disabilities across India.

A bench of Chief Justice Surya Kant and justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana asked the Centre to collect requisite data from all states and Union territories on the implementation of statutory frameworks, constitution of regulatory bodies, and oversight of such facilities, and place these on record through affidavits.

Appearing in the matter, advocate Rahul Bajaj highlighted glaring gaps in statutory compliance under both the Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 (RPwD Act) and the Mental Healthcare Act, 2017.

He submitted that rehabilitation centres for persons with disabilities mandate compulsory state-level registration under the RPwD Act and pointed out the urgent need for collection of data to establish whether the designated statutory authorities have actually been constituted across states and whether they are actively monitoring these institutions.

While referring to the Mental Healthcare Act, 2017, Bajaj flagged that only 10 states and Union territories have till now notified the requisite minimum standards for mental health establishments.

He underscored the lack of information concerning periodic audits and inspections conducted by authorities to enforce compliance and safeguard the welfare of institutionalised children.

The bench asked the Centre to coordinate with the states and compile a detailed report about setting up and functioning of statutory authorities under the RPwD Act, the formulation and notification of minimum standards across mental health establishments, and the inspection and monitoring protocols currently in place to supervise rehabilitation facilities.

It listed the matter for further hearing on October 22.

India advises nationals in Saudi Arabia to stay indoors

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi

India has issued a fresh advisory to its nationals in Saudi Arabia, urging them to remain "alert and vigilant" and follow instructions from local authorities amid the deteriorating security situation in the Kingdom following a series of Houthi attacks.

In its advisory, the Indian government asked all Indian nationals to remain cautious, stay indoors whenever necessary and closely monitor official communications from Saudi authorities.

"Indian nationals are advised to remain alert and vigilant, stay indoors as necessary, and follow the instructions issued by local authorities through official channels," the advisory said. The government has also strongly advised Indian nationals not to circulate or repost videos, photographs or news related to the ongoing events. The move is aimed at preventing the spread of unverified information during the heightened security situation.

The Embassy of India in Riyadh and the Consulate General of India in Jeddah, along with their outsourced services through VFS, continue to function normally, according to the advisory.

The Indian missions said they will continue to monitor developments and issue further updates and advisories whenever necessary. For emergency assistance, the 24x7 Pravasi Bharatiya Sahayata Kendra (PBSK) helpline is available at 8002471234. The Indian community has also been advised to follow the official social media handles of the Embassy of India for verified information and further updates. The advisory comes after recent Houthi attacks targeting Abha International Airport and King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh. According to Saudi authorities, the attacks killed three people and injured 36 others.



Two people were killed and 28 injured in the attack on Abha airport, while the strike on King Khalid International Airport left one person dead and eight injured.India has strongly condemned the attacks, calling the targeting of civilian infrastructure "completely unacceptable." The Ministry of External Affairs also expressed condolences to the families of those killed and wished a speedy recovery to those injured.India also expressed solidarity with the people and government of Saudi Arabia amid the escalation.

The attacks have also affected commercial aviation in the region. An Air India flight from Delhi to Riyadh turned back mid-air and returned to the national capital amid heightened security concerns.

Air India and Air India Express have suspended flights to and from Riyadh until October 10, as airlines reassess operations amid the evolving security situation.The latest developments have raised fresh concerns over aviation safety and the security of Indian nationals travelling to or residing in Saudi Arabia.

French student protests escalating outside Paris high school



JADE LE DELEY/LORNE COOK ■ Paris

Dozens of students dragged rubbish bins into position outside a high school in northeastern Paris early on Thursday, erecting fresh barricades before police moved in with tear gas as France's nationwide protests show few signs of ending.

The Helene Boucher Lycee has been a flashpoint for clashes in the French capital, and is one of hundreds of schools disrupted by protesters Thursday. At least a dozen demonstrations in support of the high school students' movement are planned around France later in the day.

Riot police gathered in side streets as students converged on the school. Many protesters wore surgical masks or hoodies, apparently afraid to be recognised.

Police have made more than 6,600 arrests since late September, when students, most of them under 18, started protesting to demand more education funding, according to the Interior Ministry. (*AP*)

Tanker attacked off Qatar in Persian Gulf, says UK

ASSOCIATED PRESS ■ Dubai

The British military said that several projectiles struck a tanker off the coast of Qatar, causing multiple casualties.

The United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations Centre said the attack took place in the Persian Gulf, north of Qatar's city of Madinat ash Shamal.

The UK military did not identify the tanker and did not provide any details about the casualties. There was no immediate claim of responsibility for the attack and no comment from Qatar.

Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu's former military secretary has accused the Israeli leader of altering official transcripts of phone calls from the morning of the October 7, 2023, Hamas-led attacks.



Air India flight returns to Delhi after Houthi attacks on Saudi airports

ASHOKE RAJ ■ New Delhi

An Air India flight from Delhi to Riyadh is returning to the national Capital amid heightened security concerns following a series of Houthi attacks targeting airports in Saudi Arabia that have left at least three people dead and 36 injured, according to Saudi authorities.

Air India flight AI2243 departed from Delhi and was flying south over Gujarat before proceeding over the Arabian Sea.

The aircraft subsequently turned around and is now flying back towards Delhi. The turnaround comes amid growing concerns over aviation safety in Saudi airspace following attacks on airports, including King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh. Air India and Air India Express have suspended their operations to and from Riyadh until October 10, 2026.



According to Saudi authorities attacks targeting Abha International Airport and King Khalid International Airport on October 6 and 7 killed three people and injured 36 others. Two people were killed and 28 others injured in an attack on Abha International Airport, while one person was killed and eight others injured in the attack on King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh. The Houthi group has claimed responsibility for the attacks. Its military spokesperson, Yahya Saree, said the group targeted Saudi airports using ballistic missiles and drones. Saree claimed that a ballistic missile targeting King Khalid International Airport "struck its target with precision" and disrupted airport operations.

India on Thursday condemned the attacks on Abha International Airport and King Khalid International Airport, describing the targeting of civilian infrastructure as "completely unacceptable". "India condemns the attacks over the past few days targeting Abha International Airport and King Khalid International Airport in Riyadh, which have resulted in civilian deaths and injuries," the Ministry of External Affairs said.

"The targeting of civilian infrastructure is completely unacceptable. We express our deepest condolences to the families of those who have lost their loved ones. We wish speedy recovery for those injured. We express solidarity and stand with the people and Government of the Kingdom of Saudi Arabia," it added. The latest attacks come amid renewed fighting between Saudi-backed government forces and the Iran-aligned Houthi group in Yemen.

Saree said the attacks were carried out in response to what he described as Saudi "aggression" against Yemen. He claimed that Saudi Arabia had conducted "60 airstrikes and missile attacks in the past 24 hours". The Houthi group also issued what it called a "last warning" to global airlines operating flights through Saudi airspace, saying the area had become a "theater for our military operations". Saree urged international airlines to stop operating flights through Saudi airspace, warning of the consequences of continuing to do so.

He said airspace over the "sacred areas" of Mecca and Medina was exempt from the warning. The US Mission in Saudi Arabia on Wednesday also urged American citizens to exercise heightened vigilance amid the Houthi threats. It warned that the situation could lead to flight cancellations, airspace closures and other travel disruptions.

Italy's Parliament gives final approval to Giorgia Meloni's electoral reform

GIADA ZAMPANO ■ Rome

Italy's Parliament gave final approval Thursday to a sweeping overhaul of the country's electoral system, handing Premier Giorgia Meloni a key political victory while setting up a likely constitutional battle over the reform.

The proposal — dubbed by supporters and critics alike the "Stabilicum" or "Melonellum" — is widely viewed as an attempt to strengthen Italy's political system while improving the electoral prospects of the centre-right coalition led by Meloni, which last month celebrated its record as Italy's longest-serving Government since WWII.



Supporters say the law is designed to produce clearer election winners and more stable Governments in a country known for frequent changes of administration. But the centre-left opposition dubbed it "scam law," arguing the reform is unconstitutional. It has pledged to challenge it and bring it in front of Italy's Constitutional Court once it takes effect. The Chamber of Deputies approved the measure in a secret ballot by 227 votes to 164, giving definitive parliamentary approval to the legislation after months of heated debate.The reform introduces a big majority prize that will award bonus parliamentary seats in both houses of parliament to the winning pre-election alliance, provided it wins at least 42 per cent of the national vote.

Critics contend that such a "majority prize" distorts voter representation and could conflict with previous court rulings that struck down elements of earlier electoral laws. A successful challenge could force Meloni's conservative Government to revise the system before the next general election.

The new law abolishes Italy's current mixed electoral system, in which about one-third of parliamentary seats are elected in first-past-the-post constituencies, and replaces it with a fully proportional system. Meloni's coalition says the changes will make it easier for voters to identify a governing coalition before elections and reduce the post-election bargaining that has often produced fragile Governments.

To qualify for the majority prize, parties will have to agree on a common prime ministerial candidate and political platform before the election. The vote marks Meloni's latest attempt to reshape Italy's institutional framework after voters earlier this year rejected her proposed overhaul of the justice system in a constitutional referendum. (*AP*)

South Korea tests first domestic hypersonic missile

KIM TONG-HYUNG ■ Seoul

South Korea flight-tested on Thursday its first domestically developed hypersonic weapon, designed to fly at least five times the speed of sound and evade missile defence systems, bringing Seoul closer to what it says could be game-changing weapons capabilities.

There was no immediate response from North Korea, which last week tested its own hypersonic missile that landed in the waters near Japan. South Korean President Lee Jae Myung attended the test, saying it's a major step in strengthening the country's conventional defence capabilities, according to a statement. It did not elaborate on where the test took place. The statement said the weapon separated from its booster rocket at the planned altitude, then descended and manoeuvred both vertically and horizontally before hitting a test target. It said once developed, the weapon would be able to strike key targets by surprise in the "Korean Peninsula theatre of operations." Lee stressed that South Korea "must secure our security through our own strength," and also inspected the country's most powerful Hyunmoo-5 ballistic missile on Thursday, his office said. It did not mention any direct comments by Lee on the North. Tensions between the Koreas have increased in recent weeks after three South Korean soldiers were injured in land mine explosions last month near the heavily armed inter-Korean border.



The South's military and the US-led United Nations Command concluded the blasts were caused by devices planted by North Korea, which has denied responsibility and ridiculed the South's demands for an apology.

North Korea has also stepped up weapons testing activity as its leader Kim Jong Un expands his military nuclear program while taking an increasingly hard line toward Seoul. (*AP*)

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, Laxman Singh Chauhan, along with my wife Sunita Chauhan, both residents of C-34 Garjiya Cooperative Society Abhay Khand-3, Indirapuram, Ghazibad, U.P.-201014, hereby inform the general public that we have disowned our daughter Sonika Chauhan from all our movable and immovable properties and have severed all relations with her. Henceforth, neither we nor any member of our family shall have any concern or relation with her. We and our family shall not be responsible for any act, deed, transaction, loan, liability or obligation undertaken by Sonika Chauhan. Any person dealing with her shall do so at his/her own risk

PUBLIC NOTICE

M/s Signatureglobal (India) Limited has been granted Environmental Clearance by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Government of India for proposed Mix Land Use Colony under TOD Policy Project at Village- FazilpurJharsa, Sector-71, Gurugram Manesar Urban Complex, Haryana vide EC identification no. EC26B3813HR5359939N and File No. SEAC/HR/2026/221 dated 28/09/2026. The copy of Environmental clearance along with the conditions to be complied with is available at office of the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change IA Division, and on the website at http://parivesh.nic.in and also available at the registered office of the company at 13th Floor, Dr. Gopal Das Bhawan, 28 Barakhamba Road, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001 and also on website of the company at www.signatureglobal.in.

Sd/-
Authorised Signatory
For Signatureglobal (India) Limited
CIN: L70100DL2000PLC104787
Address: 13th Floor, Dr. Gopal Das Bhawan, 28 Barakhamba Road, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001

PUBLIC NOTICE

It is to inform to the public at large that **M/S GSV SEALS PRIVATE LIMITED became owner vide Sale Deed** dated 03.02.2025 **executed by Mr. Suhail Shadab s/o Mohd. Arefeen in favour of Shri Gaurav Kumar s/o Shri Ram Prakash who is mortgaging** Built Up One Shop Bearing Pvt. no.2739/1, having its area measuring 15.40 sq. meters, on ground floor, without its roof/terrace rights, a part of free hold property bearing Municipal new no.2735-2745, situated at Ward no.I, Kashmere Gate, Delhi, building known as National Chambers, Kashmere Gate, Delhi- 110006., same to be financed by MAS Financial Services Limited **That, prior to this Suhail Shabad became owner through regd. SPA 07.08.2018 DOC. NO. 1484 and Regd. GPA 23.04.2002 doc. No. 6303 of said Property.**, If any Person having any type of claim/right/title/interest over the said property, may inform in writing, at the address mentioned below, about his objections, within **7 days** from today, failing which it shall be presumed that the said property is free from all type of Encumbrances, lien etc. **Lucem Legal LLP**
N-161, Ground Floor, Saira Tower, Gautam Nagar Near Yusuf Sarai Community Centre,New Delhi-110049
Contact # 011-40046316 & 41667327

PUBLIC NOTICE

Public at large is hereby informed that Freehold DDA built up LIG Flat No. 34, Ground Floor, Pocket 13, Sector-22, Rohini, Delhi presently owned by Smt. Sangeeta Malik and Shri Pankaj Kumar Malik by virtue of Conveyance Deed duly registered vide Regd. No. 17047, dated 03.11.2015 and the same is proposed to be offered as Security with State Bank of India, Branch : Home Loan Centre, Netaji Subhash Place, Pitampura, New Delhi and as per present owner(s) version the said property is/are free from all sorts of encumbrance. (1) ORIGINAL Allotment Cum Demand Letter dated 31.07.2006 (2) ORIGINAL Letter of Handing Over of Possession dated 19.10.2007 (3) ORIGINAL No Objection Certificate dated 19.10.2007 and (4) ORIGINAL Possession Slip dated 08.01.2008, all issued by DDA in favor of Ms Sangeeta Walia is/are reported as lost vide LR No. 705531/2026, dated 08.10.2026 with E police station Budh Vihar, Rohini District, Delhi Police, Delhi.

It is hereby notified that any person and/or Bank financial institution having any claim, any charge, Beneficiary of Will, HUF/Member of HUF, any interest or lien or claim and/or objection to thereof, he/she/ they may lodge/ notify the same to the undersigned with documentary proof/court judgment within 15 days from the day of publication of this public notice, failing which any further/future claim/objection(s) shall be rejected and my client/prospective buyer (s) as a bona-fide purchaser conclude the title/ Sale Deed proposed to be executed in favor of my client or in the name of his/her/ their nominees shall be deemed to be clear and marketable without any defect, encumbrance, flaw and impediment.

Satyender Yadav Advocate
Ch. No. 561, 5th Saket Courts, New Delhi
M. 9711212421, Email: satender175@gmail.com

PUBLIC NOTICE

This is to inform general public that Sh. Ajay has acquired Entire Upper Ground Floor without roof/terrace rights of built-up Property bearing No.RZ-A-34 (Old No.34-A), land measuring area 40 Sq. Yds., (Size 20' x 18'), out of Khasra No.102/23, 24, 105/3/1 & 4/1. Situated in the revenue estate of Village Palam, Delhi State Delhi, area abadi Known as Rajapuri, Uttam Nagar, New Delhi-110059, by way of Notarised GPA, Notarised ATS & Will dated 26.09.2020.
Now, above said owner intending to sell above said property to Mr. Tushar Jain and further Mr. Tushar Jain and Mr. Ravi Babu Jain availing a loan on above said property from Truhome Finance Limited (earlier known as Shriram Housing Finance Ltd.) in case anyone has any objection, the same may be raised within 7 days of this publication to Mr. Ajit Sharma (Advocate), Partner of AccuLaw Source LLP, Office no. 361, 2nd Floor, Sec-1, Vaishali, Ghaziabad, U.P. Pincode 201010 or contact : +91 9560309909 (M).

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the General Public on behalf of our client i.e. Saraswat Co-op Bank Ltd. that Smt. Tarun Madan is the owner of Entire Third Floor with Roof rights, (Said Floor), of Property No. J-3/2, Plot No. 2, in Block-J-3, area measuring 200 Sq. Yds., Situated at Rajouri Garden New Delhi-110027. by virtue of two separate sale deeds both dated 24.05.2022, registration No. 6277 & 6278, All persons are hereby informed that above mentioned owner wants to mortgage the said floor and intends to obtain loan from our client against the said floor, if anybody has any objection/s upon the ownership of above owner over the said floor, its sale/mortgage /litigation, & any other objections, kindly inform the undersigned in writing on the below mentioned address within 07 days of the present.

Kumar & Associates (Advocates & Consultants)
200, IInd Flr. 23, Shivaji Marg, Moti Nagar, N.Delhi-15
legal@knalegal.com Ph: 011-41112527-28

PUBLIC NOTICE

We, (i) Shri BALVINDER SINGH S/o SH. SUKHDEV SINGH & (ii) Smt. JAGDEEP KAUR W/o SHRI BALVINDER SINGH BOTH R/o H.No.97, UGF, GALI No.8, EAST GURU ANGAD NAGAR, LAXMI NAGAR, DELHI-110092, do hereby solemnly affirm and inform that Mr. AMANDEEP SINGH is our son, he has married to Mrs. GURPREET KAUR. We do hereby disowned our son Mr. AMANDEEP SINGH and Mrs. GURPREET SINGH, their son Sahajdeep Singh and his other children if any from all our moveable and immoveable properties and have reserved all our relations with them as he is disobedient, disrespectful, and out of control and mis-behaviour and other some unavoidable circumstances arises by them. Anyone dealing with them will do so at his own risk and cost, we shall not be responsible for their any act or deeds as we have no relation with them.

Balvinder Singh, Jagdeep Kaur

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, Neera Kansal W/o Late Laxmi Chand Garg R/o Flat no 304 Tower B1 IVY County Sector 75 Noida Uttar Pradesh have lost Original Allotment Letter dated 21.07.2011 for Flat no. 581, Tower I1 in Gaur Grandeur, Sector 119, Noida, issued by M/s Gaursons India Private Limited is missing GDA allotment letter on the way from my house to GDA office L. A.R No.20260000984947 dated 27/09/2026, P.S. Computer Center, Technical Services HQ, Lucknow, if you find my documents please contact with me M.No.7011028021, 9910040132 & k3.anubhav@gmail.com

THE DELHI GOLF CLUB
Dr. Zakir Hussain Road,New Delhi-03

Quotations are invited from reputed vendors for **"Purchase of Golf Caps and Golf Ball (Brand)"** Detailed RFP can be downloaded from DGC website **https://delhigolfclub.org/tendernotice/** Sealed forms mentioning word "PURCHASE OF GOLF CAPS AND GOLF BALL)" in capital letters on top of the envelope must reach us **before 15:00 Hrs. on 15thOct 2026.** Tender Box is placed in the Main Office of DGC.

Lt. Col. Rohit Singh (Retd)
Secretary
The Delhi Golf Club

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given that the **Original Sale Deed of Flat No. 09-B, Ground Floor, Tower No. 09, Gulmohar Greens, Mohan Nagar, Village Karhera, Ghaziabad, U.P.**, in the names of **Sh. Siddharth Verma S/o Sh. Madan Lal Verma** and **Smt. Kumari Jyoti W/o Sh. Siddharth Verma**, has been **lost/misplaced on 25.09.2026** near Gali No. 6, Khajoori Khas, Delhi-110094. **L.R. No. 682756/2026** dated 01.10.2026 has been lodged at **P.S. Khajoori Khas, (E-Police Station), Delhi**. Finder may contact the undersigned. Any dealing with the said document shall be at the person's **own risk**.
Owners: (1) Sh. Siddharth Verma &
(2) Smt. Kumari Jyoti
H.No. C-77, Gali No. 6, Khajoori Khas, Delhi-110094 Mob. 9811173392
Vikrant Pratap (Advocate) Ch. No. 604-A, Western Wing, Tis Hazari Court, Delhi-54. Mob. 8920618055

PUBLIC NOTICE

Notice is hereby given to the general public at large that Mrs. Khalida Begum W/o Mr. Vajid is the owner and in peaceful possession of a Residential House constructed on land measuring 80 Sq. Yards, equivalent to 66.88 Sq. Meters, being part of Khasra No. 2051, situated at Colony Sharif Beg, Village Loni Chakbandi Bahar, Pargana & Tehsil Loni, District Ghaziabad, Uttar Pradesh. The said property is claimed to have been acquired by Mrs. Khalida Begum W/o Mr. Vajid by virtue of Gift Deed dated 20.04.2026, registered as Document No. 7507, Book No. 1, Volume No. 8282, Pages 147-170, registered on 20.04.2026 in the office of Sub-Registrar, Loni, executed by Mr. Vajid S/o Mr. Ajij. The proposed borrower intends to mortgage the aforesaid property in favour of Fusion Housing Finance Ltd. for availing financial assistance. It is further informed to the general public that the following documents relating to the said property/land are stated to have been lost/misplaced by the Borrower:- 1.) Copy of Agreement to Sell in favour of Mr. Nafees Qureshi S/o Mr. Riyazuddin, in respect of land measuring 205 Sq. Yards; 2.) Copy of Agreement to Sell & Will in favour of Mr. Manju Alam S/o Mr. Umardin, in respect of land measuring 210 Sq. Yards; 3.) Original Agreement to Sell & Will in favour of Mr. Vajid S/o Mr. Ajij; and 4.) Original Sale Deed dated 23.09.2024, registered as Document No. 17191, in favour of Mr. Noor Mohammad S/o Mr. Gulzar, relating to the said property. In this regard, FIR/NCR bearing No. 3896/2013 dated 20.10.2013 and FIR/NCR bearing LR No. 705193/2026 dated 08.10.2026, have been lodged at Police Station Seelampur, Delhi, regarding the loss/misplacement of the aforesaid document. ccordingly, any person(s), having any right, title, interest, claim, objection, demand, lien, charge or concern of whatsoever nature in respect of the said property or the proposed mortgage thereof, are hereby requested to intimate/report the same in writing, along with supporting documents, at the address mentioned below within 7 (seven) days from the date of publication of this notice. In the event no objection/claim is received within the aforesaid period, it shall be presumed, subject to applicable law and verification of title documents, that there is no objection from the general public or any interested.

NCR LAW ASSOCIATES Advocate & Consultants A-98, Sector-09, New Vijay Nagar, Ghaziabad, U.P-201009
Mob. Nos. 9999721152/ 9999826427
Email Id- adv.ncrlawassociate@gmail.com

The Pioneer CLASSIFIED

CHANGE OF NAME

I, Ajay Vir, Father of- No.14857566K Sep/MT Mukesh Kumar, R/o- Vill & PO- Pisawa, Teh- Gabhana, Dist- Aligarh, U.P.- 202155, have changed my name from Ajay Vir to Ajayveer Singh, vide affidavit dated 08/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Imrati Devi, Mother of- No.14857566K Sep/MT Mukesh Kumar, R/o- Vill & PO- Pisawa, Teh- Gabhana, Dist- Aligarh, U.P.- 202155, have changed my name from Imrati Devi to Imarati Devi, vide affidavit dated 08/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Kanwara Kanwar, W/o No. 16022847M Lnk Hari Singh Rathore, R/o- Vill-Guddy, PO- Modardi, Teh-Pokaran, Dist-Jaisalmer, Rajasthan - 345021, have changed my name from Kanwara Kanwar to Kanwra Kanwar, vide affidavit dated 08/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Smt. Ibemton, W/o No. 13954223F Nk (Late) Madan Mohan Singha, R/o- Vill-Sibpur Pt II, PO- Sibpur, PS-Lakhipur, Dist- Cachar, State-Assam, Pin- 788098 have changed my daughter's name from Sangeeta Singha to Th Sanjeeta Singha vide affidavit dated 07/10/2026 before 1st Class Magistrate, Silchar, Cachar, Assam.

I, Thimmanna, Father of- No.17024213L CFN V Venkatesh, R/o H.No. 1-9, Kommur (Vill), Maddur (M), Mahabubnagar (D), Telangana- 509339, have changed my name from Thimmanna to Vepuri Thimmanna, vide affidavit dated 08/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, No. 2705106P, Hav Subhash Kumar of 18 Grenadiers C/O 56 APO R/O Gram Dilawalpur, Thulgula, Sirathu, Dist- Kaushambi, Uttar Pradesh-212204, declare that my daughter's name is wrongly mentioned as Suhani Mourya in my service records and her correct name is Suhani Maurya for all future purposes vide affidavit before Public Notary Delhi dt 07-10-2026.

I, No. 15412006N Hav S Kannan, R/o- H.No-7/54 North Street, PO- Palaiyur, Dist-Madurai, Teh- Peraiyur, Tamilnadu - 625700, have changed my mother's name in my service record from Vijaya Valli to Vijayavalli Santhanam, vide affidavit dated 08/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Sayamma, Mother of- No.17024213L CFN V Venkatesh, R/o H.No. 1-9, Kommur (Vill), Maddur (M), Mahabubnagar (D), Telangana- 509339, have changed my name from Sayamma to V Sayamma, vide affidavit dated 08/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, No.6498075K Hav Vikram Kumar Roy, R/o- Vill-Amaniganjchar, PO- Talgachi, PS+Dist- Murshidabad, West Bengal, Pin – 742149 have changed my Father's name in my Army Service Record from Shiv Muni Roy to Sew Muni Roy, vide affidavit dated 08/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, No. 6498075K Hav Vikram Kumar Roy, R/o- Vill-Amaniganjchar, PO- Talgachi, PS+Dist- Murshidabad, West Bengal, Pin – 742149 have changed my Mother's name in my Army Service Record from Chhaya Roy to Chhaya Rani Roy, vide affidavit dated 08/10/2026 before Notary Public Delhi.

I, Pradeep Kumar Mantri, resident of G/305, DMRC Staff Quarters, Shastri Park Metro Vihar, Delhi – 110053, declare that "Pradeep Mantri" mentioned in my son Sahil's Class 10th and 12th certificates, passport and my official name "Pradeep Kumar Mantri" refer to one and the same person.

I, Preety W/o Abhishek Rana D/o Sanjeev Kumar Bhasin R/o Kh No. 23/2, Janki Niwas, Gali No. 3, A Block, MBR Enclave, Pochanpur Village, Sector-23, Dwarka, Delhi have changed my name to Preety Bhasin.

I, Mohammad Latif Khan, S/o Abdul Wahid Khan, R/o R-109-B, Gali No. 7, Jogabai Extension, Jamia Nagar, New Delhi-110025, have changed the name of my 16-year-old minor son from Mohammad Anas Madani Khan to Mohammad Anas Madani for all future purposes.

I, Arun S/o Rammehar R/o Village Bashariya, Basharia (125), Baslambi, Gurugaon Haryana-122503. Hereby declare that I have changed my name from Arun Sharma to Arun for all purposes. Henceforth Arun Sharma and Arun one and the same person.

I, Manisha Devi W/o Arun R/o Village Bashariya, Basharia (125), Baslambi, Gurugaon Haryana-122503. Hereby declare that I have changed my name from Manisha to Manisha Devi for all purposes. Henceforth Manisha and Manisha Devi one and the same person.

I, Sanjeev Kumar S/o Om Parkash Handa R/o H.No-11 Road No-20 East Punjabi Bagh New Delhi -110026 have changed my name to Sanjeev Handa.

I, Md Kaish S/o Jahur Alam R/o RZ-200 Khyala Vishnu Garden Tilak Nagar New Delhi - 110018 have changed my name to Mohd Kaish Alam.

The Pioneer
NEW DELHI | FRIDAY | OCTOBER 9, 2026

Samson-Sooryavanshi dilemma resurfaces as India eye 2-0 lead against West Indies

TAPAN MOHANTA ■ Ranchi



Sanju Samson's lean run is the lone sore point in an otherwise firing batting line-up and it will prompt the team management to ponder over pairing teen sensation Vaibhav Sooryavanshi with opener Abhishek Sharma in the second T20I against the West Indies here on Friday.

A win here will power India to a 2-0 lead in the five-match series, but the hosts will certainly want a more productive outing from Samson.

The Kerala batter's last four innings read: 9, 7, 2, 11. Consequently, the partnerships involving Samson in the previous four matches stand at: 7, 12, 2 (both for 2nd wicket with Sooryavanshi coming in as opener), and 29. But the middle-order led by skipper Shreyas Iyer, who has finally found his footing as T20I captain, has covered up those failures in spectacular fashion. Iyer also hammered his maiden T20I century in the 68th match of his career.

So, there will be a temptation to give Sooryavanshi another run. The left-hander has shown that T20 cricket comes naturally to him in the limited opportunities he has received so far.

His wide and unique range of shots, coupled with the ability to produce match-winning knocks have made him a compelling package.

But India have so far backed the established opening combination of Abhishek and Samson.

The management's support of Samson was evident when he was accommodated at No.3 in the Asian Games in Japan, while giving the opening slot to Sooryavanshi.

However, Samson is yet to respond to that show of faith in him with matching performances.

In that context, the current five-match series against the Caribbeans could become significant for Samson as he cannot hang on to his World Cup performances for an eternity.

But Sooryavanshi, for all his talent, has also discovered that international cricket is a different beast.

He scored 14, 13 and 15 in India's 0-3 defeat in the T20I series against England. In the Asian Games, the Bihar batter made 18 and 35.

They are not bad scores in isolation for a beginner but they also demonstrated the fact that he cannot be rushed into top level cricket simply because of the hype around him.

India's management will therefore be thinking hard about all the corners before handing another chance to the 15-year-old.

So, that makes Friday's match less about an immediate selection call and more about the Samson-Sooryavanshi question that could grow louder as the series progresses. For Samson, the extension of the current poor run could make his position increasingly difficult to defend.

India will also look at a change in their pace-bowling combination.

Mayank Yadav leaked 16 runs in the opening over of the first T20I at Lucknow and was expensive through the middle and at the death.

He, however, claimed the important wicket of West Indies top-scorer Sherfane Rutherford in the penultimate over. India could be tempted to bring in all-rounder Nitish Kumar Reddy and trust him with the new ball, although that experiment did not work particularly well during the preceding ODI series. The spin department, on the other hand, looked settled after Kuldeep Yadav joined veteran Axar Patel in the eleven. The pair picked up two wickets apiece and kept West Indies batters under pressure. Rookie all-rounder Naman Dhir was another positive to emerge, finishing with impressive figures of 3/31 with his off-spin. For West Indies, batting has to produce far bigger total than 171 all out they managed in opening game. (*PTI*)



Experience, form helped Bhuvneshwar's recall: Kotak

TAPAN MOHANTA ■ Ranchi



Bhuvneshwar Kumar's loads of experience, coupled with his strong IPL form over past two seasons has led to his recall in India's T20I squad for New Zealand series, assistant coach Sitanshu Kotak said here on Wednesday.

The 36-year-old veteran pacer, who last played for India in November 2022 New Zealand series, has earned a well-deserved return to the national side after impressive performances for Royal Challengers Bengaluru in the IPL, having played a key role in RCB's back-to-back title triumphs in 2025 and 2026. Bhuvneshwar had taken 45 wickets across two seasons (17 in 2025 and 28 in 2026).

India will face New Zealand in a T20I series after the ongoing five-match engagement against the West Indies, and Kotak suggested that the selectors may have felt the need to add experience to an otherwise young bowling group.

"One thing is obviously with the selectors, but I can give you an answer based on what I think. In England, I personally felt that with Bumrah not being around and a lot of young bowlers playing, you can't beat experience," Kotak said at the pre-match media interaction ahead of the second T20I against West Indies. "The young bowlers are good, they are performing well and getting selected, but at some stage you also need some experience," he said.

"That might be one reason. Another thing is that Bhuvneshwar has been doing really well in the IPL for the last two seasons. So the selectors must have thought that, for New Zealand conditions and all, obviously he has been doing well and we need some experience," he said.

"They must have picked him. That's what I can think, unless you can think something different," Kotak added. (*PTI*)

Delhi LG Sandhu inaugurates DDA Sports Cup at Yamuna Sports Complex

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE ■ New Delhi

Lieutenant Governor of Delhi, Sardar Taranjit Singh Sandhu, inaugurated the opening ceremony of the DDA Sports Cup (Hockey) at the Hockey AstroTurf of Yamuna Sports Complex on Thursday. The tournament is being organised in line with the vision of the Prime Minister's Fit India Movement, launched in 2019 to encourage people, particularly the youth, to make sports and fitness an integral part of their lives. The growing participation of young people in different sporting disciplines reflects this positive change.

The event was attended by MLA Vishwas Nagar, Om Prakash Sharma, and Vice Chairman, DDA, N Saravana Kumar, along with senior DDA officials, coaches, participating teams and young hockey players.

The DDA Sports Cup brings together 11 teams from Delhi-NCR, with around 220 players, coaches and support staff participating in the tournament. The event provides young hockey players an opportunity to compete, gain match experience and showcase their talent, while promoting discipline, teamwork and sportsmanship.

The tournament is being held from 8th to 18th October, with 11th and 12th October as rest days, covering a total of nine playing days. It follows a league-cum-knockout format and will feature 20 matches, comprising 12 league matches, four quarter-finals, two semi-finals, a third-place match and the final. The final will be played on 18th October.



Hockey has a special place in India's sporting history and has inspired generations of young Indians to take up the sport. The DDA Sports Cup seeks to provide young players with competitive exposure and an opportunity to develop their skills through regular match experience.

DDA has played an important role in taking sports infrastructure closer to the people of Delhi. It currently manages 19 Sports Complexes, 04 Mini Sports Complexes and 03 Golf Courses across the city. These facilities provide opportunities for people, particularly young people, to participate in sports, pursue fitness and develop their skills.

DDA's sports facilities are also being developed as integrated spaces for sports, fitness, recreation and wellness. The recently inaugurated Sports Complex at Sector-33, Rohini, is another step in this direction and offers a range of outdoor and indoor sports facilities.

Under the guidance of Lieutenant Governor, DDA remains committed to further strengthening sports infrastructure across Delhi and creating more opportunities for budding and developing sporting talent. Through modern facilities and regular competitions, DDA seeks to encourage more young people to play, train and compete and progress towards higher levels of sporting achievement.

From village grounds to national arenas: Badnu's young daughters make their mark in cricket

PIONEER NEWS SERVICE
■ Bikaner/Mumbai/Delhi



Ritu Patwari, Director and CSR Head, Avaada Foundation with State-Level Under-17 and Under-19 girls' cricket teams from Badnu, Rajasthan PIONEER PHOTO

At a time when Indian women's cricket is inspiring millions, a group of talented girls from Badnu, a small village in Rajasthan, is scripting its own story of courage, determination and achievement. Overcoming social and financial barriers, these young athletes have represented Rajasthan at national-level tournaments, won medals and earned opportunities on prestigious sporting platforms.

This extraordinary feat has been made possible by Avaada Foundation, the social impact arm of Avaada Group, which has been supporting the Rajasthan State-Level Under-17 and Under-19 Girls' Cricket Teams from Badnu for two years and has renewed its partnership for the third consecutive year. Beyond sponsorship, the initiative reflects a sustained commitment to nurturing rural sporting talent and enabling girls to pursue their sporting and educational aspirations.

Capturing their inspiring journey, Avaada has launched "Badnu Ke Champions: Ghoonghat Se Helmet Tak," a campaign celebrating the transformation of young girls who are challenging social conventions and redefining possibilities through sport. The journey from the ghoonghat to the cricket helmet is more than a change in appearance; it symbolises a shift in mindset, growing confidence and the freedom to pursue ambitions. The campaign highlights how grassroots sporting initiatives can empower rural girls to dream beyond traditional boundaries.

The Foundation covers key expenses, including travel, accommodation, food and nutrition, sports kits, shoes, cricket equipment, tournament fees and practice facilities. It also supports players with logistics, study materials and educational expenses, ensuring that financial constraints do not impede their progress.

The initiative has already yielded remarkable results. Seven girls from Badnu played a pivotal role in helping the Bikaner team win the district-level tournament and the 69th Rajasthan State-Level Cricket Tournament, securing the Rajasthan state championship title.

Among them, Kanchan went on to represent Rajasthan at the National Championship in Rohtak, Haryana, where her contribution helped the team secure a Silver Medal.

The Under-19 team has also delivered an impressive performance. Six players from Badnu were instrumental in the team's success at the state-level tournament in Balotra, Barmer, where it finished as runner-up and qualified for the National Championship in Shivpuri, Madhya Pradesh.

Sarita emerged as the tournament's Best Bowler for her outstanding performance. She subsequently represented Rajasthan at the national level. Adding to the team's achievements, Sangeeta won a Bronze Medal and Kanchan secured a Silver Medal at the national level.

In another significant milestone, five young cricketers from Badnu, were selected to participate in trials for the opportunity to serve as net bowlers for the Delhi Capitals Women's Premier League team. This opportunity marked an important step in their sporting journeys, taking them from their village and school grounds to a professional cricket platform and giving them valuable exposure to a higher level of sport.

Commenting on the initiative, Vineet Mittal, Chairman, Avaada Group, said, "At Avaada, we believe that sport can be a powerful catalyst for inclusion, confidence and social change, particularly for young girls in rural communities. The journey of Badnu's daughters is a powerful reflection of what becomes possible when talent is given the right platform, encouragement and opportunity. Our vision is to help create an environment where girls are free to dream, compete and aspire without the barriers of circumstance defining their potential. Supporting women in sport, therefore, is not just about creating champions; it is about nurturing confidence, leadership and a generation of young women who believe they can shape their own future."

Ritu Patwari, Director and CSR Head, Avaada Foundation, said, "My association with the girls of Badnu has been deeply personal. Having seen their journey closely at the grassroots, I have witnessed not only their talent on the cricket field, but also the determination, confidence and courage with which they have overcome social and financial barriers. At Avaada Foundation, we believe that when a young girl is given the opportunity to pursue her passion, the impact extends far beyond sport. Our endeavour has been to stand beside these girls through their journey, encourage their ambitions and help create the environment they need to grow. Seeing the daughters of Badnu progress from village grounds to state and national platforms is immensely fulfilling, and I hope their journey inspires many more girls across rural India to dream without limits."

